



International Network for Aid, Relief, and Assistance

GLOBAL EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Global Policies and Country-Specific Annexes

Policy Reference: HR01 | Version 3.0 (Revised)
Effective Date: 1 July 2023 | Revised: June 2026
Classification: Internal — All Personnel

Document Control

Field	Detail
Document title	INARA Global Employee Handbook
Policy reference	HR01
Version	3.0 (Revised and expanded)
Effective date	1 July 2023
Revision date	June 2026
Authorized by	INARA International Board / President
Approved by	Senior Management Team
Owner	Human Resources Department
Applies to	All INARA personnel globally, including remote and cross-border staff and personnel of Employing Entities applying INARA standards
Review cycle	Annual, or on material change in law or organizational policy

Verification note: *Country annexes restate national statutory figures (leave, hours, notice, contributions, mandatory protections). Labour law changes periodically; each Employing Entity must verify its annex against current law with local counsel before relying on it and notify HR of any change.*

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Welcome to INARA

Message from the Board President



Welcome to the International Network for Aid, Relief, and Assistance. Without you, INARA would be unable to fulfill its mission and obligations to the countless children who rely on us for medical and mental health treatment. You are the most essential part of our organization. We depend on you to fulfill your duties in adherence to our core values of impartiality, the best interests of the child, transparency, and responsiveness.

We also depend on you to help us grow INARA into an organization that reaches well beyond its current capacity so that in the future, no conflict-impacted child is deprived of their right to heal, whether medically or mentally. I started INARA as a result of my work as a journalist, spending a decade and a half watching war-impacted children continuously unable to access the care that they need. INARA's main aim is to change that, to give the innocent a fair chance at life and alter the impact of the cruelty that has befallen them.

You have been hired because we believe you can help ensure INARA's success.

Please ensure that you read through this handbook carefully and note that we at INARA take our policies and procedures very seriously. You are expected to comply with what is outlined in the following pages.

Warmly,

Arwa Damon

Board President

Message from the Chief Executive Officer

Dear INARA Team,



Thank you for being a part of the INARA family. Each of you plays a critical role in achieving our mission to serve children and families impacted by human-induced or natural disasters. Your commitment, compassion, and professionalism directly shape the lives of those we reach—and for that, you have my deepest gratitude.

This handbook, including the policies outlined in this supplement, reflects our shared values and expectations as an ethical, globally responsible humanitarian organization. It is built on the foundational principles of accountability, transparency, equity, and respect for all. These are not just policies—they are the standards that shape our culture and safeguard the integrity of our work.

We ask every staff member, regardless of role or location, to read, understand, and adhere to these policies. Doing so ensures we maintain compliance with global NGO standards, uphold international labor and protection laws, and foster an inclusive, respectful, and safe environment for our colleagues and those we serve.

INARA is committed to continuous learning and improvement. As we grow, so too must our practices, our professionalism, and our humanity. I encourage you to stay informed, provide feedback, and support your peers in creating a workplace that embodies the very best of what we stand for.

Ethical behavior is not optional—it is essential. Whether in safeguarding, data protection, financial conduct, or community engagement, your actions must always reflect the highest standards of integrity and care. Let us continue to lead by example, hold each other accountable, and champion dignity and justice in every corner of our work.

Together, we are building something extraordinary. Let's do it with honor, empathy, and purpose.

With appreciation,

Maiwand Rohani

Chief Executive Officer

1. Definitions and Interpretation

In this Handbook, the following terms have the meanings set out below. Headings are for convenience only and do not affect interpretation. The singular includes the plural and vice versa.

NOTE

How to use this section: these defined terms apply throughout the Handbook, the annexes, and the appendices. Where a term is capitalized in the text (for example, “Employing Entity” or “Gross Misconduct”), it carries the meaning given here. Appendix L repeats a short-form version for quick reference.

Term	Meaning
INARA International	International Network for Aid, Relief, and Assistance, the U.S.-registered 501(c)(3) organization acting as parent, network coordinator, and (where applicable) grantor. INARA International is not the employer of personnel of Employing Entities and is not a party to local employment contracts.
INARA	The INARA network as a whole, including INARA International and the Employing Entities operating under INARA standards. References to actions or benefits by “INARA” in relation to employment mean the relevant Employing Entity applying INARA standards, unless the context refers to INARA International acting as parent or grantor.
Employing Entity	The locally registered organization (an independent partner organization) that employs personnel in a country of operation, signs the employment contract, runs payroll, registers staff for social security, and holds statutory employment liability under local law.
Employee	An individual engaged under a contract of employment by an Employing Entity (or, for genuinely cross-border roles, under the applicable INARA-standard arrangement).
Worker	An individual who performs work or services personally but who may not have full employee status (for example, certain casual or short-term engagements), as determined by local law.
Volunteer	An individual who supports INARA on a non-employment basis, with no salary or employment relationship; bound by the Code of Conduct and safeguarding standards.
Consultant	An individual or firm engaged under a separate services agreement for defined deliverables; not an employee.
Contractor	A third party engaged to provide goods or services under a commercial contract; not an employee.
Beneficiary	A child, family, or community member who receives INARA assistance, services, or support.
Child	Any person under the age of 18.
Vulnerable adult	Any person aged 18 or over who, by reason of disability, illness, age, trauma, displacement, or other circumstance, may be unable to protect themselves from harm or exploitation, or who depends on others for care or support.

Term	Meaning
Supervisor	The person to whom an employee directly reports for day-to-day work.
Manager	An employee with responsibility for managing other staff, resources, or functions.
Country Director	The senior person heading an Employing Entity / country program, accountable for in-country implementation.
Misconduct	Conduct or performance falling below required standards that does not, by itself, destroy the employment relationship (e.g., lateness, unapproved absence, procedural breaches); normally addressed through progressive discipline.
Gross misconduct	Serious wrongdoing that may justify summary dismissal where lawful (e.g., fraud, theft, violence, sexual exploitation or abuse, serious safeguarding breaches, serious breach of the Code of Conduct).
Conflict of interest	Any situation in which an individual's personal, financial, or family interest actually, potentially, or apparently conflicts with their duties to INARA.
Duty station	The primary location at which an employee is based and performs work, as stated in their contract.
Remote worker	An employee who performs all or substantially all of their duties away from an INARA or Employing-Entity office, whether within or outside a country of operation.
Family member	Spouse, domestic partner, parent, child, sibling, grandparent, grandchild, in-law, aunt, uncle, niece, nephew, and any person residing in the employee's household.
Safeguarding	The responsibility to protect children and vulnerable adults (and staff) from harm, abuse, neglect, and exploitation arising from contact with INARA, its personnel, or its operations.
PSEA	Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse: the standards and measures preventing sexual exploitation, abuse, and harassment of beneficiaries and community members by personnel.
Senior Management Team (SMT)	The senior leadership of INARA, led by the CEO, responsible for management, oversight, and approval of policy within delegated authority.
Employer of Record (EOR)	A properly registered third-party entity that legally employs a worker on INARA's behalf in a country where neither INARA nor an Employing Entity is registered, assuming local statutory employer obligations.
Protected characteristics	Characteristics protected under applicable law, which may include colour, nationality, ethnic or national origin, race, social origin, political opinion, religion or belief, sex, gender, gender identity, pregnancy or maternity, marital or family status, disability, health status, age, and sexual orientation.

2. About INARA

Management Structure and Governance

INARA is a non-profit corporation governed by a Board of Directors and a CEO. They are the primary policy-making authority in budget approval, legal matters, long-range planning, capital projects, and management counsel. They meet regularly with the country directors to review accomplishments, discuss current activities, approve upcoming commitments, and discuss operational issues relating to INARA's overall plan.

The Country Director heads the INARA office / Employing Entity in their country and reports to the CEO, and is responsible for implementing the goals and objectives approved for their assigned country.

At the time of hire, the employee receives an information package containing the INARA organizational charts and other INARA employees' names and positions. Project staff receive project orientation from the project managers and other staff. Organizational charts are also posted on bulletin boards, and new hires receive staff contact lists at onboarding. All incoming INARA staff are encouraged to read available resources on INARA to familiarize themselves with INARA's work and to continually seek other information to remain familiar with it.

While INARA employees are expected to project the image of the organization through their knowledge of its mission, values, history, and programs, only the President and CEO is authorized to provide public representation, press releases, media appearances, interviews, and other public materials on matters relating to INARA and its work, unless they specifically delegate that to another employee.

Who We Are

INARA, a 501(c)(3) registered charity in the United States, was founded in 2015 by Arwa Damon. At the time, she was a Senior International Correspondent with CNN and had spent more than a decade witnessing children in warzones unable to access critical medical care. Driven by a deep commitment to do more than report on their suffering, Arwa took action by creating INARA and initially funding it herself.

INARA provides access to essential medical and mental health care; humanitarian response—including food (such as hot meals, food baskets, baby formula, vegetable baskets, and fresh fruits) and non-food items (such as hygiene kits, dignity kits, winterization items, diapers, and clothing)—informal education, and shelter items for children affected by natural and human-induced disasters. These children face injuries due to human-induced and natural disasters, as well as unsafe living conditions, leading to psychological trauma and physical harm. Often, they struggle to find the support they need. At INARA, we step in to ensure they receive the necessary care to heal, recover, and reclaim their futures.

Guided by our mission to foster a future where children are empowered to shape their own dignified lives, we enhance their capacity to build fulfilling futures through integrated health, empowerment, and community-driven interventions. By addressing their immediate medical and psychological needs, we help lay the foundation for long-term strength and well-being.

We currently support children of all nationalities in Lebanon, Palestine, Egypt, Afghanistan, Ukraine, Syria, and Türkiye who require medical treatment and psychological care. Our dedicated team of caseworkers and mental health professionals is ready to intervene whenever needed, ensuring that no child is left without the care they deserve.

History

The idea behind INARA started with one Iraqi child, Youssef. In 2007, when Youssef was just five years old, he had gasoline dumped on his face and was set on fire by unknown masked men as he stood in front of his home. His father had searched desperately for medical assistance but found none. Arwa reported the story for CNN, resulting in an outpouring of support from around the world. Arwa arranged for Youssef to travel to Los Angeles to receive the surgeries and medical care he desperately needed. Now, Youssef does not remember the attack and is no longer held back by his injuries, able to live a well-rounded life full of potential. His life is no longer defined by cruelty and evil but rather kindness and compassion. That is at the core of the work that INARA does and why we believe this work is so vital: we can change the narrative of children's lives.

After Youssef, Arwa felt a profound need to do more, and something was compelling her to challenge the status quo she saw children facing repeatedly. After witnessing children become injured and suffer even more after their injuries because they fell to the wayside—forgotten about once the bombs stopped falling, unable to access care, or unable to qualify for aid—Arwa's conscience would no longer allow her to stand by.

She took action, conducted a formal needs assessment in 2015, founded and launched the International Network for Aid, Relief, and Assistance (INARA), and initially funded the organization herself. INARA was established to specifically address the gaps these children face in access to medical and mental health care and the programmatic gaps in the region, and to take on the cases that others do not.

Vision

A world where every child has the agency to create a dignified life.

Mission

Fostering a future where we empower children to shape their own dignified lives.

Purpose

Enhancing children's capacity to shape their own fulfilling futures through integrated health, empowerment, and community-driven interventions.

Core Values

- **Impartiality:** we provide equal access to services for every child in need while maintaining our independent and nonpartisan identity.
- **Best interest:** we are committed to prioritizing and advocating for the child's well-being and best interests when providing treatment and care.

- **Transparency:** we pledge to share where donations go and every child's journey toward recovery.
- **Responsiveness:** we actively respond to humanitarian crises in our areas of operation, evolving and adapting to situations as they happen.

3. About This Handbook

Welcome to INARA! We hope your work will be fulfilling, productive, and successful. INARA is committed to establishing clear, practical legal rules and procedures to govern its offices and manage staff. This handbook describes the policies, procedures, and benefits for INARA employees and should be read together with each employee's contract of employment and the applicable country-specific annex.

As an employee of INARA, it is important that you be familiar with, understand, and comply with the policies and procedures outlined in this handbook. If there are any parts of this handbook you do not understand or about which you have questions, please discuss them with your supervisor or designated Human Resources representative. An employee who does not adhere to the policies and procedures outlined in this manual may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including dismissal from INARA employment.

Who This Handbook Applies To

This Employee Handbook covers all personnel working globally. It has been prepared with reference to global best practices of the NGO sector. This includes all personnel working globally without exception, whether nationals or foreigners, except those excluded by separate regulations. National staff are those who live and work in their country of permanent residence. This handbook sets out the terms and conditions of employment and should be read in conjunction with the employment contract.

Employer Identity and Relationship of Entities

This is a foundational provision and prevails over any contrary impression elsewhere in this Handbook. INARA delivers its programs through independent, locally registered partner organizations ("Employing Entities"). The Employing Entity in each country is the employer of the personnel working in that country: it concludes the employment contract, runs payroll, registers staff with the relevant social-security and tax authorities, and bears statutory employment liability under local law.

- INARA International acts as parent, network coordinator, and (where applicable) grantor. It is not the employer of Employing-Entity personnel and is not a party to local employment contracts.
- INARA International's standards, ethics, safeguarding, PSEA, anti-fraud, and data-protection requirements are binding through (a) incorporation into the local employment contract as required standards, (b) the partnership / funding agreement (MOU) between INARA International and the Employing Entity, including audit rights and indemnities, and (c) this Handbook as the global standard the Employing Entity applies.
- Nothing in this Handbook is intended to create a joint-employer, co-employer, agency, or partnership relationship between INARA International and any Employing-Entity employee, or to make INARA International liable for the statutory employment obligations of an Employing Entity.

- References in this Handbook to “INARA” providing a benefit, exercising a right, or taking an action in relation to employment mean the relevant Employing Entity applying INARA standards, unless the context refers to INARA International acting as parent or grantor.

Employee Responsibility

All staff on employment contracts will receive and sign a copy of this handbook. The signature will indicate that the staff member has read, understood, and accepted the rules and regulations set out in this staff handbook.

These rules and regulations form an integral part of the contract of employment, in which they are expressly incorporated by reference, subject to mandatory applicable law and to the individual contract, which prevails in the event of conflict. They may be revised as and when the situation requires, by coordinated approval between the Country Director and INARA Senior Management, and will be shared with all relevant staff.

The overall responsibility for the management of staff lies with the employer (the Employing Entity). Each manager is responsible for the performance of the staff members reporting to them and is accountable for conducting their performance evaluations.

All staff must sign the INARA Code of Conduct, the Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse policy, the Child & Vulnerable Adult Protection policy, and the Ethical Concerns and Duty to Report policy as a pre-condition of employment.

Status of this Handbook

- This Handbook is incorporated by reference into the contract of employment as a statement of applicable standards and expectations, subject to mandatory applicable law and to the individual contract, which prevails in the event of conflict.
- Provisions that describe discretionary benefits, allowances, processes, or arrangements are non-contractual guidance and may be varied, withdrawn, or applied flexibly by the Employing Entity or INARA, subject to law. Core obligations relating to conduct, safeguarding, ethics, confidentiality, and compliance are binding.
- Where any provision conflicts with the mandatory law of the duty station, that mandatory law prevails to the extent of the conflict; the remainder continues to apply (severability).
- No failure or delay in enforcing a provision is a waiver of it. A one-off concession does not create a precedent or entitlement.

Handbook Amendment Procedure

- **Who may amend:** the Human Resources Department prepares amendments; material changes are approved by the Senior Management Team and, where they affect governance or core policy, noted to the Board.
- **How employees are notified:** approved changes are communicated to staff in writing (email and/or the staff portal); significant changes are accompanied by a briefing where appropriate.
- **Effective date:** each revision states an effective date; changes apply prospectively unless a later date or legal requirement provides otherwise.

- **Supersession:** a new version supersedes all previous versions from its effective date; superseded versions are retained for record only.
- **Consultation:** where local law requires consultation or agreement before a change takes effect, the Employing Entity follows that requirement.

Reservation of Rights

- INARA and each Employing Entity reserve the right to amend, interpret, or withdraw policies and procedures at any time, subject to applicable law and contractual obligations.
- Operational, security, funding, or legal circumstances may require exceptions to ordinary practice; such exceptions are approved and documented under the Policy Exception Process.
- Benefits, allowances, and discretionary arrangements may change subject to law, funding availability, and operational needs.
- Exercising management discretion under this Handbook does not, by itself, create a contractual entitlement.

Policy Framework and Hierarchy

This Handbook establishes the global human resources governance framework for INARA and defines the hierarchy, authority, and interaction of all human resources policies, procedures, and contractual arrangements across the organization. INARA operates across multiple jurisdictions with varying legal, regulatory, and operational environments; accordingly, a structured policy hierarchy is required to ensure clarity, consistency, and compliance while maintaining operational flexibility.

A. Policy Hierarchy Structure

Level	Document Type	Scope	Function
Level 1	Global HR Handbook	Organization-wide	Establishes core principles, policies, and standards (highest internal authority).
Level 2	Country Annexes	Country-specific	Adaptation to local legal and operational context; overrides global policy where required by law.
Level 3	Standard Operating Procedures	Functional / departmental	Define implementation processes; subordinate to Handbook and Annexes.
Level 4	Employment Contracts	Individual employee	Define individual employment terms; subordinate to all above, subject to law.

B. Governing Principles

- **Consistency:** INARA maintains a unified global standard for employment practices across all countries of operation.
- **Legal compliance:** all policies must comply with applicable local labour laws, regulations, and administrative requirements.

- **Subsidiarity:** country-specific provisions apply only where necessary to address legal or operational differences.
- **Non-derogation:** no lower-level document may reduce or contradict protections established at higher levels, or non-waivable statutory rights.
- **Clarity and transparency:** all policies, procedures, and contractual terms must be clearly documented and communicated.

C. Conflict Resolution Within the Framework (Order of Precedence)

In the event of inconsistency or conflict between documents, the following order of precedence applies: (1) applicable mandatory local law; (2) Country Annex; (3) Global HR Handbook; (4) Standard Operating Procedures; (5) Employment Contract. Where a conflict exists between internal documents, the higher-ranking document prevails unless otherwise required by law. Where INARA policy provides greater protection or benefit than local law and is lawful to apply, the higher standard may be applied; stricter donor requirements apply in addition.

D. Contractual Compliance

- All employment contracts must be consistent with the Global HR Handbook and the applicable Country Annex;
- Any contractual provision inconsistent with higher-level policies or applicable law is null and void to the extent of the inconsistency;
- Contracts may include additional provisions, provided they do not reduce employee rights or organizational obligations established under this framework.

E. Authority and Oversight

- The Human Resources Department maintains, updates, and interprets this policy framework;
- Senior Management ensures alignment with organizational strategy and compliance requirements;
- Country Directors ensure proper implementation at country level;
- Any deviations must be formally approved and documented (see Policy Exception Process).

Application Across Countries and Conflict of Laws

INARA operates in diverse and often complex environments, including jurisdictions with differing legal systems, enforcement mechanisms, and operational constraints. This section establishes how the Global Handbook and Country Annexes apply across all countries of operation.

A. General Applicability

- The Global Handbook applies to all INARA employees, regardless of duty station or contract type;
- Each employee is additionally subject to the Country Annex applicable to their primary duty station;
- Country Annexes provide legally required modifications and contextual adaptations to the Global Handbook.

B. Multi-Jurisdictional and Cross-Border Operations

- For employees operating across multiple jurisdictions (remote roles, cross-border assignments, or regional functions), the primary duty station determines the applicable Country Annex;
- Additional legal or administrative requirements from secondary locations may also apply where relevant;
- Remote and cross-border staff are governed in full by this Global Handbook, subject to the Remote and Cross-Border Work policy and applicable mandatory local law.

C. Where Local Law Is Unclear

Where local law is unclear, inconsistently enforced, or operationally impractical, INARA applies the provision that best ensures legal compliance to the extent possible, protection of employees, continuity of operations, and alignment with humanitarian principles. Country offices must seek guidance from HR in cases of ambiguity or conflict; complex or high-risk matters are escalated to Senior Management, with legal counsel consulted where necessary.

4. Humanitarian Principles and Accountability

Humanitarian Principles

INARA upholds the core humanitarian principles in all its work:

- **Humanity:** human suffering must be addressed wherever found; the dignity and rights of all people must be respected and protected.
- **Neutrality:** INARA does not take sides in hostilities or engage in controversies of a political, racial, religious, or ideological nature.
- **Impartiality:** assistance is provided on the basis of need alone, without discrimination, prioritizing the most urgent cases.
- **Independence:** INARA's humanitarian action is autonomous from political, economic, military, or other objectives.

Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP)

INARA is accountable to the children, families, and communities it serves. Staff support and respect mechanisms that give affected populations a voice in the assistance they receive:

- **Information sharing:** communities receive accessible, accurate information about INARA, its services, and how to raise concerns.
- **Participation:** affected people are consulted and involved in decisions that affect them, to the extent feasible and safe.
- **Feedback and complaints:** accessible, safe, and confidential channels allow beneficiaries to provide feedback or raise complaints, including about staff conduct; complaints are acknowledged, handled, and used to improve programs.

Protection Mainstreaming

INARA mainstreams protection across all activities, ensuring that programs uphold:

- **Safety and dignity:** avoiding causing harm; prioritizing the safety, dignity, and rights of affected people.
- **Meaningful access:** ensuring access to assistance proportionate to need and without barriers or discrimination.
- **Accountability:** setting up appropriate feedback and complaints mechanisms.
- **Participation and empowerment:** supporting the development of self-protection capacities and assisting people to claim their rights.

Gender Equality and Inclusion

INARA is committed to gender equality and to the inclusion of all groups, including persons with disabilities, older persons, and marginalized communities, in both its workforce and its programs. INARA works to remove barriers to participation, to ensure equitable access to services and opportunities, and to prevent discrimination in all forms. Beyond policies and procedures, INARA is dedicated to an inclusive workplace culture where diversity is valued and all employees feel

welcome, through open dialogue, mutual respect, mentorship, and active participation in shaping the environment.

Localization

Consistent with its model of working through locally registered partner organizations, INARA supports localization: strengthening local leadership, capacity, and decision-making, and channeling resources and responsibility to local actors where aligned with INARA's strategy, donor requirements, and compliance standards.

Environmental Responsibility

INARA seeks to minimize the environmental impact of its operations through responsible use of resources, reduction of waste, and consideration of environmental sustainability in procurement, travel, and program design, to the extent feasible in its operating contexts.

5. Recruitment and Hiring

INARA recruits on merit, through a fair and transparent process, and screens candidates appropriately given its work with children and vulnerable adults. Recruitment is conducted by the Employing Entity, applying INARA standards and the requirements of donors and applicable law.

Recruitment and Selection

Equal Opportunity

Recruitment is open and merit-based, free from discrimination on any protected characteristic. Selection is based solely on the requirements of the role and the candidate's ability to meet them. INARA actively seeks a diverse pool of candidates and provides reasonable adjustments for applicants with disabilities during the recruitment process.

Vacancy Advertising

- Each vacancy is based on an approved job description and person specification setting out duties, required qualifications, experience, and competencies;
- Vacancies are advertised through appropriate internal and external channels for a reasonable period to reach a diverse pool; internal candidates may apply;
- Advertisements state that INARA is an equal-opportunity, safeguarding-committed employer and that appointment is subject to satisfactory checks.

Selection Criteria and Candidate Evaluation

- Selection criteria are defined in advance from the job description and applied consistently to every candidate;
- Applications are screened against the essential criteria to produce a shortlist; the basis for shortlisting is recorded;
- Candidates are assessed objectively using role-relevant methods (structured interview, and where appropriate written test, presentation, or work sample);
- Each candidate is scored against the criteria; the evaluation, the reason for selection, and the reason unsuccessful candidates were not selected are documented and retained for audit and fairness.

Interview Standards

- Interviews are conducted by a panel of at least two people wherever feasible, to reduce individual bias;
- All candidates for a role are asked the same core, role-relevant questions; questions about protected characteristics (such as marital status, pregnancy, religion, or health) are not asked;
- Safeguarding-relevant roles include values-based and scenario questions to explore attitudes to child protection and PSEA;
- Interview notes and scores are recorded and retained.

IMPORTANT

Document the decision. Recruitment is one of the most common sources of discrimination and unfair-treatment complaints. Keep the job description, shortlisting notes, interview scores, and the selection rationale on file. If a decision is challenged, contemporaneous records are the primary defence.

Background Verification

Offers of employment are conditional and made in writing, subject to satisfactory completion of pre-employment checks. Checks are conducted lawfully, proportionately, with the candidate's knowledge and consent, and in line with data-protection law. The following are completed before the start date wherever possible, or as soon as practicable thereafter:

- **Reference checks:** at least two references, including the most recent employer; references for safeguarding-relevant roles specifically ask about any safeguarding concerns.
- **Employment verification:** confirmation of previous positions, dates, and reasons for leaving.
- **Education and professional verification:** confirmation of qualifications, registrations, or licences required for the role.
- **Identity verification:** confirmation of identity against valid official documentation.
- **Right-to-work verification:** confirmation that the candidate is legally entitled to work at the duty station, including any required permit or visa.

NOTE

Where a check cannot be completed before the start date (common in some operating contexts), the conditional nature of the offer is recorded in writing, the outstanding check is completed as soon as possible, and the appointment may be withdrawn if a check is unsatisfactory, subject to local law.

Safeguarding Screening

Because INARA works with children and vulnerable adults, safeguarding screening is mandatory for relevant roles, to the fullest extent permitted by local law. Safeguarding-relevant roles include any role with contact with, or access to information about, children or vulnerable adults, and all management roles.

- **Criminal-record / police checks:** obtained where lawful and available for the duty station.
- **Child-protection and PSEA screening:** including, where applicable, references and checks under inter-agency misconduct-disclosure schemes (for example, the inter-agency misconduct disclosure scheme) to identify prior sexual exploitation, abuse, or harassment findings.
- **Sanctions and counter-terrorism screening:** screening of candidates against applicable sanctions and designated-persons lists (see also Section 17).

- **Disclosure requirements:** where lawful to ask, candidates must disclose any prior safeguarding finding, dismissal for misconduct, or relevant criminal conviction; failure to disclose is a ground for withdrawal or dismissal.

CAUTION

Never waive safeguarding screening to fill a role quickly. Appointing a person to a safeguarding-relevant role without the required screening exposes children, the organization, and donor funding. If screening cannot be completed, the person must not have unsupervised contact with children or vulnerable adults until it is.

Misrepresentation

Honesty in the application process is a condition of employment. The following are grounds for withdrawal of an offer or, if discovered after hire, for disciplinary action up to and including summary dismissal, subject to applicable law and due process:

- Falsified or exaggerated qualifications, registrations, or experience;
- False or misleading information in an application, CV, or interview;
- Fraudulent or fabricated references;
- Concealment of information the candidate was lawfully required to disclose (including a relevant conviction or prior safeguarding finding).

6. Employment Standards

Fair Employment and Non-Discrimination

INARA is committed to fair, equitable, merit-based personnel practices in recruitment, placement, transfer, promotion, compensation, and termination. INARA does not discriminate on the basis of any protected characteristic to the extent protected under applicable law, and does not tolerate discrimination by or against staff, partners, or beneficiaries.

Employee Categories

- **National staff:** employed by the Employing Entity in their country of recruitment; terms governed by local law and the country annex.
- **International / cross-border staff:** engaged to work outside their country of nationality or across borders; terms defined by contract and INARA global policy, subject to host-country requirements and the Remote and Cross-Border policy.
- **Temporary and fixed-term:** engaged for a defined period or project; ends at term unless extended.
- **Casual / daily workers:** intermittent engagement; governed by local law and the terms of engagement.
- **Consultants and contractors:** engaged under separate agreements for defined deliverables; not employees.
- **Volunteers and interns:** non-employment basis; bound by the Code of Conduct and safeguarding standards.

Probation

Newly hired employees serve a probationary period (ordinarily up to three months, unless local law or the contract provides otherwise) to assess performance, conduct, and suitability. Probation is monitored by the supervisor; where permitted by law it may be extended on written notice before the initial period ends. Successful completion is confirmed in writing. (See also Probation Reviews under Performance Management.)

Hiring of Relatives (Anti-Nepotism)

Recruitment is merit-based. Employees must disclose any personal or family relationship with a candidate or employee that may create a conflict of interest, and must not participate in recruiting, selecting, supervising, or evaluating a family member or domestic partner. INARA will not place individuals where a personal relationship creates a reporting line between related persons or an unmanageable conflict of interest.

Reasonable Accommodation and Disability

INARA supports an inclusive environment and, where reasonably possible and without undue hardship, makes appropriate accommodations to enable employees with disabilities to perform their roles. Where an employee cannot perform essential functions despite reasonable

accommodation, INARA explores alternatives (reassignment, adjusted duties, extended leave) before considering termination, and only in accordance with applicable law.

Personnel Files

Each employee has a confidential personnel file maintained by the Employing Entity in accordance with data-protection law. Access is restricted to authorized persons on a need-to-know basis. Employees may request to review their file and to request correction of inaccurate information, in accordance with policy and law. Records are retained for the period required by local law.

7. Mobility, Transfers, and Secondments

Internal Transfers

- **Country and internal transfers:** INARA may transfer or reassign employees between roles, teams, or locations based on operational needs, subject to law, the contract, and reasonable consultation.
- **Cross-border transfers:** a move to another country ordinarily requires a new or amended contract with the relevant Employing Entity (or an appropriate cross-border arrangement), addressing immigration, tax, and social-security implications.
- **Temporary assignments:** employees may be assigned temporarily to another role or location to meet operational needs, for a defined period.
- **Acting appointments:** an employee may be asked to act in a higher or different role temporarily; any acting allowance and duration are agreed and documented.

Secondments

Employees may be seconded to a partner organization, another country office, or a donor-funded project for a defined period. A secondment agreement sets out the host arrangement, reporting lines, duration, who bears salary and costs, and the employee's return arrangements. The substantive employment relationship with the home Employing Entity continues unless expressly agreed otherwise, subject to law.

Promotion Framework

- **Eligibility:** based on a vacancy or expanded role, satisfactory performance, and meeting the requirements of the higher position.
- **Criteria:** merit, demonstrated competencies, performance record, organizational need, and funding availability.
- **Approval:** recommended by the supervisor and approved by the Country Director in coordination with HR; documented, with any change to classification and compensation confirmed in writing.

Demotion and Reassignment

- **Voluntary demotion:** an employee may request a move to a lower-graded role; agreed in writing with corresponding terms.
- **Organizational restructuring:** roles may change following restructuring; affected employees are consulted and supported in accordance with law.
- **Performance-related reassignment:** where performance does not meet the requirements of a role, reassignment to a more suitable role may be considered as an alternative to termination, following due process and subject to law.

8. Working Arrangements

Remote and Cross-Border Work

INARA offers remote work where feasible and aligned with the role. Remote and cross-border staff are governed in full by this Global Handbook, subject to applicable mandatory local law.

Approved Work Location and Employer-of-Record

- Remote work is permitted only from a work location approved in writing in advance. INARA maintains an approved-country list; work from a non-approved location requires prior written approval.
- Where an employee works from a country in which neither INARA nor an Employing Entity is registered, INARA engages the individual through an Employer-of-Record (EOR) or an equivalent compliant arrangement, so that local employment, tax, and social-security obligations are met by a properly registered entity. INARA International is not the employer in such cases.
- INARA may decline, limit, or end a remote arrangement, or require relocation to an approved location, where compliant engagement is not feasible.

Employee Responsibilities

Because remote and cross-border arrangements depend on the employee's chosen location, the following are the employee's responsibility:

- Obtaining and maintaining their own right to work, immigration status, visas, and permits for their location;
- Filing and paying their own personal income tax and any personal contributions where local law places these on the individual;
- Disclosing their actual country and place of work, and keeping INARA informed of any change; and
- Not relocating their work location without prior written approval.

The employee represents that they are lawfully able to work remotely from their stated location. Mandatory employer obligations imposed by the law of the employee's actual location are met by INARA only through a properly registered entity or EOR; an employee who works from an unapproved location does so contrary to policy and bears the consequences of that choice, to the extent permitted by law.

IMPORTANT

Where you work matters legally. Working from a country INARA has not approved can create tax, immigration, and "permanent establishment" liabilities for you and the organization. Always get written approval for your work location before you start or relocate, and tell HR if your actual country of work changes.

Home Office, Equipment, and Confidentiality

- **Home office:** remote employees maintain a safe, suitable, reasonably ergonomic workspace.
- **Equipment:** INARA provides necessary tools and technology; employees safeguard equipment, use it for work, and return it on request or separation.
- **Internet and connectivity:** employees maintain reliable connectivity sufficient for their role; eligible costs may be partially reimbursed under internal guidelines.
- **Confidentiality and security:** employees use secure, approved networks and systems, comply with data-protection and IT-security policies, and report any security risk immediately.

Hybrid Work

- Hybrid arrangements combine office and remote work on an agreed schedule;
- Attendance expectations (required in-office days, team coordination, and meetings) are set by the supervisor and documented;
- Employees remain available during core hours and meet the same performance and conduct standards as office-based staff.

Flexible Working Requests

- **Application:** employees may submit a formal written request for flexible working (hours, pattern, or location).
- **Approval criteria:** requests are assessed against operational needs, role suitability, team coverage, and fairness, and a decision is given within a reasonable time.
- **Review:** approved arrangements may be reviewed and adjusted based on performance or operational change, with reasonable notice.

Business Continuity and Emergency Working

- In emergencies, pandemics, security incidents, or other disruptions, INARA may require employees to work remotely, relocate, or follow alternative arrangements to maintain operations and staff safety;
- The Country Director may authorize temporary office closure; employees follow continuity instructions and remain contactable;
- Business-continuity measures are temporary and proportionate, and ordinary arrangements resume when feasible.

9. Working Hours and Attendance

Standard Work Schedules

Standard working hours, the workweek, and rest days are determined by applicable local law and the country annex. Given the nature of humanitarian work, employees may occasionally be required to work outside normal hours to meet operational or emergency needs, in accordance with law.

Attendance Requirements

- **Punctuality:** employees are expected to start work on time and be present for scheduled hours and meetings.
- **Reporting absence:** employees must notify their supervisor as early as possible (ordinarily before the start of the working day) of any absence, and provide required documentation.
- **Timekeeping:** employees accurately record working time, attendance, and leave in accordance with procedures; falsifying time records is misconduct.

Breaks and Rest Periods

Employees are entitled to meal and rest breaks in accordance with local law and the country annex. Employees should take their entitled breaks; daily and weekly rest periods required by law must be respected, including in field operations, subject to genuine emergency needs.

Overtime, Weekend, and On-Call Work

- **Overtime:** must be pre-approved by the supervisor; eligibility, limits, and rates are governed by local law and the annex; unauthorized hours are not compensated except in approved emergencies.
- **Weekend / rest-day work:** requires prior approval; compensated by additional pay or time off in lieu in accordance with local law and the annex.
- **On-call work:** where a role requires on-call availability, expectations and any on-call or call-out compensation are defined in the contract or local policy and applied consistently with law.
- **Compensatory time off:** where permitted, time off in lieu is taken within a reasonable period as defined by local procedures.

Temporary Office Closure

The Country Director may authorize temporary closure due to security, natural disaster, public-health emergency, or other operational risk; employees may be required to work remotely or follow alternative arrangements.

10. Leave Management

Leave entitlements are determined by applicable local law and the country annex; the categories below set the global framework. Part-time and fixed-term staff accrue leave pro rata. All leave must be requested and approved in advance through the leave-management process, except genuine emergencies notified as soon as possible.

Public Holidays

INARA observes the official public holidays of each country, per the annex. Work on a public holiday, where required, is compensated per local law and policy.

Annual Leave

Annual leave supports rest and well-being; entitlement is set by the annex and contract. The leave year is 1 January to 31 December unless local law provides otherwise. Employees are expected to plan and use their leave within the leave year.

Leave Carry-Forward

NOTE

Plan your leave. You may carry a maximum of five (5) days into the next leave year (more only if local law requires). Anything above that is lost, so agree a leave plan with your supervisor early and take your entitlement within the year.

- A maximum of five (5) days of annual leave may be carried forward into the following leave year, unless local law requires a higher amount;
- Employees are responsible for planning their annual leave and discussing it with their supervisor to avoid excessive accrual;
- Carried-forward leave above the permitted maximum expires unless local law requires otherwise or management approves an exception in writing.

Sick Leave

Sick leave is provided per local law and the annex. Employees must notify their supervisor as soon as possible on the first day of absence and provide a medical certificate where required. INARA may, where lawful and justified, request verification or an approved-practitioner assessment. Prolonged or repeated absence is managed supportively, with termination considered only after reasonable accommodation and in accordance with law.

Maternity, Paternity, and Parental Leave

Maternity, paternity, adoption, and parental leave, breastfeeding/nursing breaks, and stillbirth leave are provided in accordance with local law and the annex, including protection of employment and return-to-work arrangements.

Other Leave

- **Bereavement leave:** on the death of an immediate family member, including time to attend the funeral, per local law and the annex.
- **Compassionate leave:** for family emergencies or other exceptional circumstances, at management discretion.
- **Marriage leave:** on the employee's marriage, per local law and the annex.
- **Family care leave:** to care for a sick immediate family member, per local law and policy.
- **Emergency leave:** for unforeseen personal emergencies, notified as soon as possible.
- **Study and examination leave:** for approved professional development or academic examinations, subject to operational needs and approval.
- **Religious leave:** reasonable provision for religious observance, consistent with operational needs and local practice.
- **Hajj / pilgrimage leave:** where provided by local law and the annex.
- **Jury / civic-duty leave:** where applicable under local law, on production of official documentation.
- **Unpaid leave:** may be granted on written request, subject to approval and law.

Leave Approval and Cancellation

- **Approval authority:** leave is approved by the supervisor (and, where required, the Country Director), balancing operational needs and fairness.
- **Timelines:** leave should be requested with reasonable notice; emergencies are notified as soon as possible.
- **Cancellation:** in exceptional operational circumstances, approved leave may be adjusted or cancelled, with balances updated accordingly.
- **Unauthorized absence:** absence without approval or valid justification may be treated as unpaid and may lead to disciplinary action; prolonged unauthorized absence may be treated under the abandonment-of-employment provisions.

11. Compensation and Benefits

Salary Administration

INARA aims to pay fair, reasonable salaries appropriate to the role, the candidate's qualifications and experience, and the operating context. Because INARA operates across countries with significant cost-of-living and currency fluctuation, a single standard salary scale may not be applicable in every context; where INARA operates a salary scale, salaries refer to it, taking into account local conditions and the nature of the work. In all cases, the salary is fair and is discussed and pre-agreed with the candidate during the interview stage and confirmed in the contract.

Payroll Errors

- **Overpayments:** where an employee is overpaid in error, the overpayment is recoverable; recovery is arranged reasonably (typically by agreed instalments), in accordance with local law.
- **Underpayments:** where an employee is underpaid, the shortfall is corrected promptly on verification.
- **Reporting:** employees should check payslips and report any suspected error to HR/Finance without delay.

Salary Advances

PROCEDURE

How to request a salary advance: (1) you must have completed 6 months' continuous service; (2) the amount may not exceed 50% of one month's salary; (3) your supervisor recommends it; (4) the CEO approves it; (5) it is recovered from your following salary by agreement and in line with local law.

- A salary advance of up to 50% of one month's salary may be requested after completion of six (6) months' continuous service with INARA;
- Advances are recommended by the supervisor and approved by the CEO;
- The advance is recovered from subsequent salary by agreement and in accordance with local law.

Allowances

- **Transportation:** during working hours, and where the law requires it, employees are provided with transportation or an equivalent amount added to salary.
- **Communication:** INARA provides an official phone number and, where necessary, a phone, to be used strictly for official purposes.
- **Housing:** INARA does not provide housing. For official visits to countries where INARA operates, staff stay in the INARA guest house if available; otherwise in a hotel at reasonable cost.

- **Per diem:** staff travelling outside their duty station for official visits receive per diem under the per diem policy, or actual travel expenses are reimbursed.

Insurance

- **Medical insurance:** provided for full-time staff where required by local law. Remote staff are not included under this policy.
- **Travel insurance:** the employee arranges travel insurance when required for travel.

Note: *Where local mandatory law requires the Employing Entity to provide a particular insurance or benefit to an employee, that obligation applies regardless of the general statements above.*

Pension and Retirement

Pension and retirement arrangements follow the applicable national social-security / pension system and local law, as set out in the country annex. INARA does not impose a mandatory retirement age unless required by law. Any statutory retirement entitlements are processed through the relevant national system.

Job Titles, Pay Increases, and Career Development

- Job titles are assigned for organizational and payroll purposes; pay increases are not automatic and depend on performance, funding, local conditions, and approval;
- INARA encourages professional growth through internal opportunities, training, and expanded responsibilities; employees may apply for internal vacancies subject to standard procedures.

12. Performance Management

Performance Appraisal and Planning

Performance management supports effectiveness, growth, and accountability. A formal review is conducted at least annually, reviewing the prior period's performance and conduct and setting objectives and a development plan for the year ahead. Performance management is continuous; employees should receive regular feedback throughout the year.

Probation Reviews

- **Midpoint review:** the supervisor reviews progress partway through probation, gives feedback, and identifies any support needed.
- **End-of-probation review:** before the end of probation, the supervisor assesses suitability and recommends confirmation, extension (where lawful), or, where standards are not met, action in accordance with law.

Performance Improvement Plans (PIP)

- **Criteria:** where performance falls short, a PIP sets clear, measurable objectives, the support provided, and a defined review period.
- **Monitoring:** progress is reviewed at agreed intervals with documented feedback.
- **Outcomes:** successful completion confirms satisfactory performance; failure to improve may lead to reassignment or termination, following due process and subject to law.

Multi-Source (360-Degree) Feedback

Where feasible and appropriate to the role, INARA may use multi-source feedback (from supervisors, peers, direct reports, and cross-functional colleagues) to provide a balanced assessment and support development. Feedback is constructive, professional, given in good faith, and handled confidentially.

Development Plans and Professional Development

Employees are encouraged to develop their skills through annual learning plans, training, mentoring, and practical experience. Activities are approved in advance, aligned with organizational priorities, and subject to operational needs, budget, and donor restrictions.

Succession Planning and Talent Management

INARA supports continuity through leadership development and talent management: identifying critical roles, developing internal capability, and planning for transitions, particularly for leadership and specialized technical positions.

13. Workplace Conduct

Workplace Civility and Professional Communication

All personnel are expected to treat colleagues, partners, beneficiaries, and the public with respect, courtesy, and professionalism. Communication should be clear, respectful, and constructive, in person and in writing, including email and messaging. Disrespectful, demeaning, or aggressive behavior is not acceptable.

Harassment

INARA does not tolerate harassment — unwelcome conduct that affects employment conditions, unreasonably interferes with work, or creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive environment, including verbal, visual, physical, or electronic conduct, and gender-based or sexual harassment. Sexual harassment (unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favours, or other conduct of a sexual nature) is prohibited. Violations are subject to discipline up to termination. Concerns should be reported to the supervisor, Country Director, HR, or a reporting channel under Section 21.

Bullying

Bullying is repeated, unreasonable behavior directed at a person or group that creates a risk to health, safety, or dignity — for example, persistent unjustified criticism, humiliation, intimidation, exclusion, or the misuse of power or authority. Bullying, including by a person in a position of authority, is prohibited and treated as a conduct matter. A single serious incident may also be addressed under this policy. Reasonable, lawful management action conducted in a fair way (such as performance management or reasonable instructions) is not bullying.

Workplace Relationships

- INARA respects employees' private lives. However, a romantic or intimate relationship between employees can create conflicts of interest, particularly where one party supervises, evaluates, or influences the employment of the other.
- Employees in such a relationship where a reporting or supervisory line exists (directly or indirectly) must disclose it to HR or the Country Director so that conflicts can be managed (for example, by adjusting reporting lines).
- An employee must not supervise, evaluate, make employment decisions about, or sit on a selection or disciplinary panel concerning a person with whom they have a close personal or intimate relationship.
- Relationships with beneficiaries are prohibited (see PSEA and the Code of Conduct).

Recording of Conversations

Employees must not make audio or video recordings of meetings, conversations, or calls involving colleagues, beneficiaries, partners, or others without the knowledge and consent of those being recorded, except where expressly authorized and lawful. Covert recording is a conduct matter. Where recording is part of an authorized process (for example, a documented investigation or

consented interview), the participants are informed and applicable law and data-protection requirements are followed.

Gifts, Hospitality, and Loans

Employees must not use their position for personal benefit and must not accept gifts, hospitality, loans, or favours that could reasonably be perceived to influence their judgment. Modest, culturally appropriate tokens of nominal value may be accepted only where refusal would be impractical or insensitive, must not create a conflict of interest, and must be declared. Soliciting gifts or accepting loans or advantages from partners, vendors, beneficiaries, or related parties is prohibited. (See the Gifts and Hospitality Register and Conflict of Interest provisions in Section 17.)

Dress, Substances, and Political Activity

- **Professional dress:** appropriate to the working environment, respectful of local norms, and mindful of safety and practicality in the field.
- **Tobacco, alcohol, and drugs:** tobacco is prohibited on premises and in vehicles except in designated areas where permitted; illegal drugs are prohibited; employees must not work impaired; alcohol during working hours or duties is prohibited unless expressly authorized for a specific event.
- **Political activity:** INARA is non-partisan; personal political activity is confined to private capacity and outside working hours, must not use INARA resources, and must not imply INARA endorsement.
- **Outside employment:** requires prior written approval and must not conflict with duties, INARA's interests, or impartiality.

Confidentiality

Employees must keep confidential all non-public information about INARA, its staff, beneficiaries, partners, and donors, and use or access such information only as required for their duties and in compliance with data-protection law. Confidentiality obligations continue after employment ends (see Section 27).

14. External Engagement, Social Media, and Media

Representation and External Communication

All external communication must be accurate, professional, and consistent with INARA's mission, values, and approved messaging. Only authorized persons may speak on behalf of INARA. Employees must protect confidential and beneficiary information and adhere to safeguarding and ethical standards when sharing information, images, or stories.

Social Media

- **Personal accounts:** employees are personally responsible for their content; personal views must not be presented as INARA's, and employees should make clear they speak for themselves.
- **Organizational branding:** only authorized persons post on or manage INARA's official channels and use INARA's name, logo, and brand.
- **Political content:** employees must not post political content in a way that associates INARA with a party, candidate, or partisan position, consistent with neutrality.
- **Beneficiary content:** employees must never post images, names, or identifying details of beneficiaries (especially children) without proper, informed consent and adherence to safeguarding and dignity standards; sensitive or degrading content is prohibited.
- **Public commentary:** employees exercise discretion to avoid reputational, security, or safeguarding risk to INARA, beneficiaries, or colleagues, including in groups and comments.

Media Engagement

Media interviews, public speaking, and publications relating to INARA require prior authorization through the communications protocol. Only the President/CEO or a written delegate provides press statements, interviews, or public materials on behalf of INARA. Employees approached by media should refer the request to the authorized contact.

15. Information Technology

Acceptable Use

IT resources are provided primarily for work; limited reasonable personal use is permitted where it does not interfere with duties, security, or cost. IT systems, data, and equipment remain INARA property; INARA may monitor and access use in accordance with applicable law and its data-protection policy. Illegal, unauthorized, or inappropriate use is prohibited. Employees must return all equipment and materials on separation or request.

Cybersecurity

- **Passwords:** use strong, unique passwords; do not share or reuse credentials; store them securely.
- **Multi-factor authentication:** enable and use MFA on all systems where it is available or required.
- **Device security:** keep devices locked, encrypted where provided, and up to date; report lost or stolen devices immediately.
- **Threat awareness:** remain alert to phishing and social-engineering; do not click suspicious links or disclose credentials; report incidents promptly.

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) Tools

- AI tools may be used only for permitted purposes and in line with INARA policy and approvals;
- Confidential, personal, or beneficiary data must not be entered into external or public AI tools, as this may expose protected information;
- Beneficiary and protection-sensitive data must never be processed through AI tools without explicit authorization and appropriate safeguards;
- Use of AI for any new or sensitive purpose requires prior approval; employees remain responsible for the accuracy, appropriateness, and confidentiality of AI-assisted outputs.

Data Storage and Devices (BYOD)

- **Approved systems:** store INARA and beneficiary data only on approved systems and storage; do not store it on unauthorized personal cloud or local storage.
- **Personal devices (BYOD):** where personal devices are permitted for work, they must meet security requirements (passcode, encryption where available, up-to-date software, approved apps); INARA may require security controls and the removal of INARA data on separation. Sensitive beneficiary data should not be held on personal devices.

16. Safeguarding

INARA is committed to the protection and welfare of the children and vulnerable adults it serves. INARA maintains a zero-tolerance approach to sexual exploitation, abuse, and harassment, and to any harm to children or vulnerable adults. All personnel and volunteers must comply with this section, the Code of Conduct, and the PSEA standards as a condition of engagement.

Child and Vulnerable Adult Protection

INARA opposes all forms of abuse and upholds applicable host-country, international, and (where relevant) US legal requirements on the rights and protection of children and vulnerable adults. Staff and volunteers must observe the following protective rules:

CAUTION

The two golden rules. Never be alone with a child or vulnerable adult where others cannot see and hear you, and never sleep in the same room or bed as a child or vulnerable adult. If a situation forces an exception (a genuine emergency), make it observable, end it as soon as possible, and report it immediately.

- Staff and volunteers must never be alone with a child or vulnerable adult (other than their own child) in a private place, or in any place where other responsible adults cannot easily observe and overhear the interaction.
- Staff and volunteers must never sleep in the same room or bed as a child or vulnerable adult.
- Staff and volunteers must never discipline a child or vulnerable adult physically, or hit or otherwise physically assault them, even where locally accepted.
- Staff and volunteers must not shame, humiliate, belittle, or degrade a child or vulnerable adult, or perpetuate any form of abuse, including harmful traditional or ritualistic practices.
- Staff and volunteers must not touch a child or vulnerable adult inappropriately (a general guideline is not to touch areas normally covered by shorts and a t-shirt).
- Staff and volunteers must not use offensive language, or expose a child or vulnerable adult to pornographic or inappropriate material.
- Staff and volunteers must not share alcohol, tobacco, or drugs with a child or vulnerable adult, or be intoxicated in their presence.
- Staff and volunteers must not engage or transport a child or vulnerable adult without the consent of a parent or guardian; where transport is necessary, at least one other adult must be present.
- Staff and volunteers must never take or produce images of a child or vulnerable adult that are humiliating, degrading, or sexually suggestive; subjects must be adequately clothed in any image.
- Staff and volunteers must comply fully with applicable national and international (and, where relevant, US) requirements on reporting maltreatment of minors.

Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA)

- Sexual exploitation and abuse by personnel constitute gross misconduct and are grounds for summary dismissal.
- Sexual activity with a child (under 18) is prohibited regardless of the local age of consent; mistaken belief about age is not a defence.
- Exchange of money, employment, goods, services, or assistance for sex is prohibited.
- Sexual relationships with beneficiaries are prohibited, given the inherently unequal power dynamics.
- All personnel must help maintain an environment that prevents sexual exploitation and abuse; managers are accountable for prevention systems.

Safeguarding Reporting Procedure

IMPORTANT

If you have a concern, report it — do not investigate it yourself. Report within 24 hours to any safeguarding channel (line manager, HR, Country Director, Safeguarding Focal Point, or the independent Board route if leadership may be involved). You do not need proof; a reasonable suspicion is enough. Protect the child's safety first, keep information confidential, and never confront the alleged perpetrator.

- **Duty to report:** any person who becomes aware of, or reasonably suspects, a safeguarding or PSEA concern must report it without delay and ordinarily within 24 hours through a safeguarding channel; a reporter is never required to report through a person who may be implicated.
- **Channels:** reports may be made to a line manager, HR, the Country Director, the designated Safeguarding Focal Point, or the independent Board escalation route for concerns involving senior leadership (see Section 21).
- **Escalation:** serious safeguarding concerns are escalated promptly to the Safeguarding Focal Point and senior management, and to authorities and donors where required, in line with the safeguarding procedure.
- **No retaliation:** good-faith reporters are protected from retaliation.

Survivor-Centered Approach

INARA applies a survivor-centered approach: the rights, needs, wishes, safety, dignity, and confidentiality of the survivor guide decisions. Survivors are treated with respect and without judgment, are supported in accessing appropriate medical, psychosocial, and protection services, and give informed consent before information is shared, subject to mandatory legal reporting and to risk-of-harm exceptions.

Safeguarding Investigations

- Safeguarding concerns are investigated promptly, fairly, and confidentially by appropriately trained personnel who are independent of the matter;

- Information is shared strictly on a need-to-know basis; the safety of the survivor and any child is the priority;
- Interim measures (such as suspension on full pay, or adjusted duties) may be taken to protect those at risk while an investigation proceeds;
- Findings are documented and acted upon, including disciplinary action and referral to authorities where appropriate.

Mandatory Reporting

Where national law imposes mandatory reporting of abuse, exploitation, or harm (including of minors), INARA and its personnel comply with those obligations. Country annexes set out the local mandatory-reporting requirements that apply at each duty station.

17. Ethics and Compliance

Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal, financial, or family interests conflict, or appear to conflict, with their duties to INARA. No employee may use their position, or information obtained through it, for personal gain, or act to benefit a firm in which they or a family member have an interest.

Conflict of Interest Declaration

Employees in decision-making, procurement, finance, recruitment, or management roles complete an annual conflict-of-interest declaration and update it promptly when circumstances change. Declared conflicts are managed by mitigation (such as recusal from the relevant decision, closer oversight, or reassignment of the decision).

Gifts and Hospitality Register

Offers of gifts or hospitality (whether accepted, declined, or returned) above a nominal value defined in the Anti-Fraud and Anti-Corruption Policy must be recorded in the Gifts and Hospitality Register maintained by the Employing Entity / HR. The register is available for review and audit.

Related-Party Transactions

Transactions between INARA (or an Employing Entity) and a related party — including a board member, employee, or their family member, or an entity they control — must be disclosed, conducted at arm's length, justified, approved by an appropriate authority independent of the related party, and documented. Undisclosed related-party transactions are a serious compliance breach.

Political Neutrality

INARA is non-partisan and neutral. Employees must not commit INARA to a political party, candidate, or partisan cause, use INARA resources for political purposes, or engage in public campaigning on behalf of INARA. Legitimate, evidence-based advocacy on humanitarian and protection issues, where consistent with INARA's mission and approved through proper channels, is distinct from partisan political activity and must remain within approved advocacy boundaries.

Sanctions Compliance

- As a US-registered organization operating in high-risk and sanctioned environments, INARA must ensure its funds and assets do not benefit designated individuals or entities.
- Employees must comply with applicable sanctions regimes (including, where relevant, those administered by the US Office of Foreign Assets Control and other authorities) and with donor counter-terrorism-financing requirements.
- Employee responsibilities include cooperating with screening and due-diligence procedures for recruitment, partners, procurement, and disbursements; not entering transactions with designated parties; and immediately escalating any possible sanctions or counter-terrorism-financing exposure to management and Finance/Compliance.

LEGAL PROTECTION

Sanctions exposure is organizational and personal. As a US-registered charity working in sanctioned and high-risk environments, INARA must ensure no funds, goods, or services benefit a designated person or entity. Screen partners, vendors, and payees as required, never bypass screening to move quickly, and escalate any possible match or counter-terrorism-financing concern to Finance/Compliance before proceeding. A breach can jeopardize donor funding and INARA's legal standing.

18. Anti-Fraud and Anti-Corruption

INARA maintains zero tolerance for fraud, corruption, bribery, money laundering, and diversion of funds or assets. This section sets out core principles; detailed procedures are in the Anti-Fraud and Anti-Corruption Policy.

Core Obligations

- No bribery, kickbacks, secret commissions, or improper advantages, directly or through third parties;
- No misappropriation, misuse, or diversion of funds, assets, or in-kind resources, including donor funds and beneficiary items;
- Accurate, complete records; no falsification of documents, timesheets, receipts, beneficiary lists, or financial records;
- Compliance with procurement, finance, and delegation-of-authority procedures; no circumvention of financial controls.

Reporting Procedures

Suspected fraud or corruption must be reported promptly through any channel in Section 21, including the independent Board escalation route where senior management may be involved. Reports may be made confidentially or anonymously; good-faith reporters are protected from retaliation.

Investigation Process

Reports are assessed and, where warranted, investigated fairly, objectively, and confidentially under the Investigations procedure (Section 20). Interim measures, including suspension on full pay, may be applied to protect the investigation.

Recovery of Losses

Where fraud or corruption causes loss, INARA seeks recovery of the misappropriated funds or assets, including through disciplinary, civil, or criminal means and through the relevant insurance or partner indemnities, in accordance with law.

Cooperation Obligations

All personnel must cooperate fully and honestly with fraud and corruption investigations and audits, preserve relevant records, and not destroy, alter, or conceal evidence. Failure to cooperate, or obstruction, is itself a disciplinary matter.

19. Data Protection, Intellectual Property, and Well-Being

Data Protection and Privacy

CAUTION

Beneficiary data can put people at risk. In conflict settings, a leaked list of names, locations, health conditions, or protection cases can endanger lives. Collect the minimum necessary, store it only on approved encrypted systems, share strictly on a need-to-know basis, never put it in personal email or public AI tools, and report any suspected breach immediately.

INARA complies with applicable data-protection laws (including, where applicable, the EU GDPR and equivalent national laws). Access to personal and beneficiary data is restricted on a least-privilege, need-to-know basis; data is stored securely with encryption and access controls; personal data is shared only on a lawful basis; and special care applies to beneficiary and protection-sensitive data, including minimization and informed consent. Suspected or actual breaches must be reported immediately to IT, HR, and the Data Protection focal point, with notification where required by law. Data is retained only as long as necessary and securely disposed of. Data subjects may exercise their rights of access, correction, and (where applicable) deletion and objection.

Intellectual Property

Intellectual property created during employment, using INARA resources, or in connection with duties is owned by INARA. Employees must not use INARA IP for personal purposes or distribute it without written permission, must maintain confidentiality during and after employment, and must return or securely delete IP materials on separation. INARA does not claim ownership of work created after employment ends except to the extent it incorporates INARA confidential information or pre-existing INARA IP; ordinary skills and knowledge gained remain the employee's own.

Conflict Sensitivity and Do No Harm

INARA applies a conflict-sensitive, "Do No Harm" approach, continuously assessing how its presence and activities affect community dynamics, promoting fairness and impartiality, engaging stakeholders transparently, avoiding harmful narratives, and adjusting where harm is identified, in collaboration with local actors.

Mental Health and Well-Being

INARA recognizes the emotional and psychological demands of humanitarian work and is committed to a supportive environment. Where feasible and subject to funding and context, INARA facilitates access to confidential support, awareness and manager training, manageable workloads, and peer support, and seeks to reduce stigma so staff feel able to seek help.

20. Investigations

INARA investigates allegations of misconduct, policy violations, fraud, financial or procurement irregularities, workplace-conduct matters, or safeguarding concerns fairly, objectively, and confidentially. This section sets the standard organizational investigation framework that applies to all such matters; the procedure is summarized in Appendix K, and detailed steps may be set out in a separate Investigation Standard Operating Procedure. Safeguarding investigations also follow Section 16.

Investigation Principles

- **Procedural fairness:** the person under investigation is informed of the allegations (so far as consistent with the integrity of the process and any safeguarding risk), given a fair opportunity to respond, and treated as innocent until findings are made.
- **Independence and objectivity:** the investigator is impartial and not connected to the matter; conflicts of interest are avoided.
- **Proportionality and timeliness:** the investigation is proportionate to the allegation and completed without undue delay.

Evidence Gathering

Investigators gather relevant evidence — documents, records, electronic data, and other materials — lawfully and proportionately, and preserve it securely with a clear chain of custody. Relevant records must be preserved once an investigation is foreseeable or underway (see Record Preservation, Section 27).

Witness Interviews

Witnesses are interviewed separately, informed of the confidential nature of the process, and asked to provide a truthful account; interview notes are recorded. Witnesses and reporters who participate in good faith are protected from retaliation.

Confidentiality

Information about an investigation is shared strictly on a need-to-know basis. Participants must keep the matter confidential. Personal data is handled in line with the Data Protection policy.

Findings and Outcomes

The investigator documents findings on the balance of probabilities and a recommendation. Outcomes may include no action, management action, disciplinary action under Section 23, referral to authorities, or loss recovery. The relevant decision-maker, who is separate from the investigator where feasible, decides on outcomes.

Appeals

Where a disciplinary outcome follows an investigation, the employee may appeal under the disciplinary appeal process (Section 23). An appeal is heard by a person not previously involved in the decision, where feasible.

Administrative Leave (Suspension Pending Investigation)

Suspension pending investigation is a neutral precautionary measure on full pay, not a sanction. Where it is necessary to protect an investigation, other staff, beneficiaries, or evidence, an employee may be suspended on full pay while the matter is investigated. Suspension is for the shortest period reasonably necessary, does not imply guilt, and is kept confidential. Loss of pay is only applied as a sanction after a fair process and a finding, and only where local law permits; unpaid suspension before any finding is not used, as it is unlawful in most jurisdictions and exposes INARA to claims.

LEGAL PROTECTION

Why suspension is on full pay. Suspension pending investigation is a neutral, precautionary step, not a punishment. Removing pay before any finding of wrongdoing is treated in most of INARA's jurisdictions as an unlawful deduction or a disciplinary sanction imposed without due process, and is a common trigger for abusive-dismissal and unpaid-wages claims. Keeping suspension on full pay protects both the employee's rights and the organization.

21. Reporting Channels and Whistleblower Protection

INARA requires personnel to report suspected wrongdoing — including breaches of law or policy, safeguarding or PSEA concerns, fraud, corruption, harassment, or other misconduct — and protects those who report in good faith.

Reporting Channels

A reporter may use whichever channel is most appropriate and safe, and is never required to report through a person who may be implicated:

- The line manager;
- The Human Resources Department;
- The Country Director;
- The designated Safeguarding / Ethics Focal Point or reporting committee; and
- An independent escalation route to the Board (or a Board-designated committee) for concerns involving senior management, the CEO, or any person to whom the other channels report.

Anonymity and Confidentiality

Reports may be made openly or anonymously; identification is optional. INARA reviews and acts on credible anonymous reports, while recognizing that anonymity may limit investigation and follow-up. INARA makes reasonable efforts to keep a reporter's identity and information confidential and limits access to those handling the matter. Confidentiality cannot be guaranteed in all circumstances: disclosure may be required to investigate thoroughly, to comply with law, or to ensure a fair process. Reporters who wish to remain anonymous should avoid including identifying details they do not wish to share. Reports and personal data are handled under the Data Protection policy.

Protection from Retaliation

Retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith or participates in an investigation is strictly prohibited and is itself a serious disciplinary matter. Protection does not extend to a person who has themselves engaged in misconduct, and managers retain authority to take lawful action based on legitimate performance or conduct concerns. Knowingly false or malicious reports are not protected.

22. Grievance Handling

A grievance is a concern, problem, or complaint an employee raises about their work, working conditions, or treatment. INARA encourages early, informal resolution and provides a fair formal process where needed.

Informal Resolution

Wherever possible, an employee raises the matter directly with their supervisor (or, where the supervisor is the subject, with the next-level manager or HR), who seeks to resolve it promptly and fairly.

Formal Complaint

- If informal resolution is not possible or appropriate, the employee submits a written grievance to HR or the Country Director;
- The grievance is acknowledged and investigated by an appropriate person who is not the subject of the complaint;
- The employee may be accompanied by a colleague at any grievance meeting where local practice or law provides;
- The outcome is communicated to the employee in writing within a reasonable time.

Timelines, Appeals, and Documentation

- **Timelines:** grievances are acknowledged promptly (ordinarily within five working days) and concluded without undue delay.
- **Appeals:** an employee dissatisfied with the outcome may appeal to a more senior manager or HR, who reviews the matter and gives a final decision.
- **Documentation:** grievances, investigations, outcomes, and appeals are documented and retained confidentially.

23. Discipline

Discipline is applied fairly, consistently, and proportionately, in accordance with local law and following due process. Save in cases of gross misconduct (where summary dismissal may be lawful), INARA applies progressive discipline and gives the employee notice of the concern and an opportunity to respond before a decision.

Progressive Discipline

Stage	When used	Form
Informal counseling	Minor or first-time concerns	Documented discussion and guidance
Verbal warning	Continued or more serious minor misconduct	Recorded verbal warning
Written warning	Repeated or more serious misconduct	Formal written warning
Final written warning	Persistent or serious misconduct	Final warning stating consequences of further breach
Suspension	Pending investigation, or as a sanction where lawful	On full pay if precautionary; see Section 20
Dismissal	Failure to improve, or serious/gross misconduct	Termination with or without notice as lawful

The employee is informed of the allegation, given an opportunity to respond (and to be accompanied where local practice provides), and notified of the decision in writing with reasons. The employee may appeal to a person not previously involved in the decision, where feasible. Records of all disciplinary action are retained confidentially.

PROCEDURE

The standard sequence: (1) informal counseling → (2) verbal warning → (3) first written warning → (4) final written warning → (5) dismissal. Each stage records the concern, the improvement required, the support offered, and the review date. Stages may be skipped where the misconduct is serious enough to justify it, but the employee must always be heard before a decision. See Appendix I for the flowchart.

Gross Misconduct — Examples

The following are examples of conduct that may constitute gross misconduct and may justify summary (immediate) dismissal without notice, subject to a fair process and local law. The list is illustrative, not exhaustive:

- Fraud, theft, embezzlement, or misappropriation of funds, assets, or beneficiary items;
- Bribery, kickbacks, corruption, or money laundering;
- Falsification, forgery, or destruction of records, documents, timesheets, receipts, or beneficiary lists;
- Sexual exploitation or abuse of a beneficiary or community member (PSEA violation);

- Any sexual activity with a child (a person under 18), regardless of local age of consent;
- Sexual harassment, or serious harassment, of a colleague, beneficiary, or partner;
- Serious breach of safeguarding standards, or failure to report a known safeguarding concern;
- Physical violence, assault, fighting, or serious threatening or intimidating behavior;
- Possession, use, or distribution of illegal drugs on duty or on INARA premises; being unfit for work through alcohol or drugs;
- Unauthorized possession or use of weapons on INARA premises, in vehicles, or on INARA business;
- Serious breach of confidentiality, or deliberate misuse or unauthorized disclosure of personal, beneficiary, or donor data;
- Serious or deliberate breach of data-protection or IT-security rules, or deliberate introduction of malicious software;
- Serious or deliberate breach of security or safety rules endangering self or others, or refusal to follow a lawful security instruction (e.g., evacuation);
- Diversion or misuse of donor funds, or transactions with sanctioned or designated parties;
- Serious insubordination or wilful refusal to carry out lawful, reasonable instructions;
- Discrimination, bullying, or victimization of a serious nature;
- Retaliation against a whistleblower, complainant, witness, or participant in an investigation;
- Deliberately false, malicious, or fabricated allegations or reports;
- Obstruction of, or failure to cooperate with, an investigation or audit; destruction or concealment of evidence;
- Serious conflict of interest or related-party transaction deliberately concealed;
- Acting beyond delegated authority to bind or commit INARA, causing or risking serious loss;
- Serious misrepresentation of qualifications, identity, or right to work;
- Abuse of position for personal gain, or soliciting gifts, loans, or favours from partners, vendors, or beneficiaries;
- Bringing INARA into serious disrepute through conduct on or off duty;
- Conviction of a serious criminal offence relevant to the role or to INARA's integrity;
- Abandonment of post in a manner that endangers beneficiaries, colleagues, or operations.

IMPORTANT

Even for gross misconduct, follow a fair process. Summary dismissal still requires that the employee be told the allegation, given a genuine opportunity to respond, and that the decision be based on evidence and documented. Skipping due process is the single most common reason dismissals are overturned and damages awarded — regardless of how serious the underlying conduct was. When in doubt, suspend on full pay and investigate before deciding.

24. Health, Safety, and Security

INARA is committed to safeguarding the health, safety, and security of its personnel and takes all reasonable measures to provide a safe working environment, including in complex, high-risk, and conflict-affected settings. Employees share responsibility for safety and must comply with all safety and security policies, briefings, instructions, and clearances. This section sets the standards; detailed operating procedures are held in the Security Management Plan and Standard Operating Procedures for each country.

IMPORTANT

In a life-threatening emergency, act to protect life first. Personal and team safety always takes priority over assets, programs, or property. Follow the instructions of your security focal point and the country Security Management Plan, then report as set out below.

Occupational Health and Safety (OHS)

Organizational Responsibilities

- Provide a safe working environment, assess and mitigate workplace risks, and provide relevant safety information, equipment, and training;
- Maintain premises, equipment, and systems in safe condition and conduct periodic workplace inspections;
- Ensure compliance with applicable local OHS law (see the Statutory Compliance Summary in each annex).

Employee Responsibilities

- Follow safety procedures and use provided safety equipment;
- Take reasonable care for their own safety and that of colleagues, beneficiaries, and visitors;
- Not undertake work they are not trained or authorized for, and not endanger themselves or others;
- Report hazards, unsafe conditions, injuries, and near-misses promptly.

Hazard Reporting and Workplace Inspections

- Any employee who identifies a hazard (electrical, structural, fire, environmental, ergonomic, or security-related) must report it to their supervisor or the safety focal point without delay;
- Workplaces are inspected periodically; identified risks are logged, prioritized, and remediated, with corrective actions tracked to completion;
- Serious or imminent risks must be escalated immediately and the affected area made safe.

Accident and Incident Reporting

- **Immediate action:** ensure safety, provide or summon first aid, and prevent further harm.

- **Reporting:** all work-related accidents, injuries, occupational illnesses, and near-misses are reported to the supervisor or safety/security focal point as soon as possible and recorded in the incident register.
- **Timelines:** serious incidents are reported immediately (verbally) and in writing within 24 hours; reporting to authorities follows the timeframe required by local law (set out in the annex).
- **Investigation:** incidents are investigated proportionately to identify root causes and prevent recurrence; corrective actions are documented and tracked.

First Aid and Fire Safety

- **First aid:** each workplace has accessible first-aid provision and, where feasible, trained first-aiders; employees should know how to access first aid and emergency assistance and the location of the nearest medical facility.
- **Fire safety:** employees must know evacuation routes, assembly points, and the location of fire exits, extinguishers, and alarms; fire equipment is maintained and drills are held where feasible.
- **Evacuation drills:** employees must participate in drills and follow the instructions of fire wardens / floor marshals.

Security Incident Reporting and Escalation

- Security incidents, threats, intimidation, theft, and suspicious activity must be reported immediately to the supervisor and the security focal point;
- The security focal point logs the incident, assesses risk, and implements mitigating measures;
- Serious incidents are escalated without delay to the Country Director and, where required, to senior management and the Board, following the duty-of-care and crisis-management procedures.

Critical Incident Management

A critical incident is a serious event that threatens life, safety, or the continuity of operations. INARA maintains crisis-management arrangements for such events. On a critical incident, the Country Director activates the Crisis Management Team; personnel must follow instructions and the priority order is: (1) preserve life and safety, (2) account for all personnel, (3) stabilize the situation, (4) communicate through authorized channels only, and (5) recover and learn.

Critical incident	Immediate priority actions
Kidnapping / abduction	Activate Crisis Management Team; preserve life; do not negotiate or pay outside the established protocol; control communications; notify senior management, the Board, and (per protocol) authorities, insurers, and the family.
Armed conflict / attack / active threat	Move to safe location or hibernation; account for all staff; follow security instructions; cease movement until cleared.

Critical incident	Immediate priority actions
Serious injury / medical emergency	Provide first aid; arrange medical evacuation or transport to the nearest appropriate facility; notify focal point and next of kin per protocol.
Death of personnel	Secure the scene; notify the Country Director and senior management immediately; follow the death-notification procedure below; preserve dignity and confidentiality.
Detention / arrest of staff	Notify senior management and legal counsel; do not make admissions; arrange legal and consular support per protocol.
Natural disaster / fire	Evacuate to assembly point; account for staff; follow emergency services; do not re-enter until cleared.

Serious Injury and Death Notification

- Serious injury or death is reported immediately (verbally) to the Country Director and CEO, and in writing as soon as practicable;
- Next of kin are notified compassionately and promptly through the designated person, following the protocol; the deceased's dignity, family wishes, and cultural and religious practices are respected;
- INARA coordinates with authorities, insurers, and (for international staff) the relevant embassy, and provides support to the family and affected colleagues;
- Final payments and benefits are processed to the legally recognized beneficiary or estate (see Section 26).

CAUTION

Communications discipline. During a critical incident, only the CEO or an authorized spokesperson communicates externally or with media. Staff must not post about the incident on social media or disclose names, locations, or details, which can endanger colleagues, compromise a response, or distress families before notification.

Evacuation, Hibernation, and Relocation

Where the security situation deteriorates, INARA may direct one of the following, based on threat assessment and the Security Management Plan:

- **Hibernation:** staff shelter in a secure location and suspend movement until the threat subsides.
- **Relocation:** staff are moved to a safer location within the country.
- **Evacuation:** staff are moved out of the area or country; national and international staff arrangements follow the security plan and duty-of-care obligations.

Employees must comply with evacuation, hibernation, and relocation instructions without delay. Refusal to follow a lawful security instruction may endanger others and is a disciplinary matter. INARA bears reasonable costs of organization-directed relocation and evacuation in accordance with policy.

Rest, Recuperation, and Hazard-Related Provisions

- **Rest and recuperation (R&R):** where provided for a duty station, eligibility, frequency, and entitlements follow the R&R policy for that location and funding; R&R is for well-being and is taken as scheduled.
- **Hazard / hardship provisions:** where applicable for a high-risk or hardship duty station, any hazard or hardship arrangement is defined in the contract or local policy and applied consistently; it is contingent on the duty station and funding and is not a permanent entitlement.
- **Medical and travel cover:** see Section 11 (Insurance) and the country annex; travel to higher-risk locations requires clearance (Section 25).

NOTE

R&R, hazard, and hardship provisions vary by duty station, donor funding, and security level. They are confirmed in the contract or a country-specific arrangement; this Handbook sets the framework, not a universal entitlement.

Duty of Care, Staff Well-Being, and Stress Management

INARA owes its personnel a duty of care and takes reasonable steps to manage risk; in turn, employees are personally responsible for complying with security protocols, briefings, travel clearances, and instructions. Working in INARA's operating environments involves inherent risk that INARA manages but cannot eliminate.

- Managers promote manageable workloads and rest, recognize signs of stress, burnout, and trauma, and signpost support;
- Where feasible and subject to funding and context, INARA facilitates access to psychosocial support and critical-incident support following distressing events;
- Pre-deployment briefings and, where relevant, post-incident debriefs are provided for high-risk roles.

25. Vehicles and Travel

Vehicle Use and Driver Authorization

- **Driver authorization:** only drivers authorized in writing by INARA, holding a valid and appropriate licence, may operate INARA or hired vehicles on INARA business.
- **Licensing:** drivers must hold and maintain a valid licence for the vehicle class and comply with all licensing, registration, and insurance requirements; licences are verified and recorded.
- **Vehicle inspections and maintenance:** vehicles are kept roadworthy, serviced, and insured; drivers complete basic pre-use checks (tyres, lights, fuel, brakes, fluids, first-aid kit) and report defects; defective vehicles are not used.
- **Authorized use:** INARA vehicles are used for official purposes only unless otherwise authorized; a logbook records journeys, mileage, and fuel.

Driving Rules

- Every occupant of an INARA vehicle, or a private vehicle used for INARA business, must wear a working seat belt at all times;
- Use of a mobile phone or device while driving is prohibited except via a lawful hands-free system where permitted; texting while driving is always prohibited;
- Driving under the influence of alcohol or drugs is strictly prohibited; a zero-alcohol rule applies to anyone driving on INARA business;
- Drivers must obey all traffic laws, speed limits, curfews, and security instructions, must not exceed safe driving hours, and must not drive while fatigued;
- No unauthorized passengers; transport of beneficiaries follows safeguarding rules (Section 16); no weapons in INARA vehicles.

CAUTION

Seat belts and no phone, every trip. Road traffic accidents are among the most common causes of serious injury and death for humanitarian staff. Seat belts are mandatory for all occupants on every journey, and handheld phone use while driving is never permitted.

Accident Procedures

- Stop, ensure safety, and provide or summon first aid and emergency services as needed;
- Do not admit liability or sign documents you do not understand;
- Notify the supervisor and security focal point immediately;
- Report the accident to the police where required by law or where there is injury or significant damage, and obtain a copy of the police report where one is issued;
- Notify the insurer within the timeframe required by the policy, through the focal point;

- Record details (location, time, parties, witnesses, photographs where safe) and follow insurance and reporting procedures; the accident is logged and investigated.

Travel Authorization and Safety

- **Authorization:** all official travel is authorized in advance and conducted under the Travel, Finance, and Security policies.
- **Security clearance and risk assessment:** travel to or within higher-risk areas requires security clearance and a documented risk assessment, and may be restricted, escorted, or refused on security grounds.
- **Traveler responsibilities:** visas, documentation, required vaccinations, security briefings, check-in protocols, and travel insurance where required (Section 11).
- **Tracking and communication:** travelers follow movement-tracking and check-in requirements so their location and safety are known.
- **Cost:** reasonable, necessary travel expenses are reimbursed on valid documentation; resources are used cost-effectively.

Travel Recovery

Employees travelling for extended periods, including over weekends or outside normal hours, may be granted travel recovery time, subject to operational needs and supervisor approval. Travel recovery time does not accrue and is not payable on separation.

26. Termination of Employment

All terminations are conducted fairly, lawfully, and with due process, in accordance with local law, the contract, and the country annex. Consistent with this Handbook, no severance schedule is set out here; any statutory end-of-service entitlement is governed solely by applicable local law and the contract.

Resignation

An employee resigning must give written notice to their supervisor or Country Director, observing the contractual and statutory notice period, and cooperate in a full handover. The Employing Entity may, in accordance with law and contract, accept immediate resignation, require the employee to leave before the end of notice, or place the employee on garden leave, with pay and benefits provided as required by law.

Retirement

There is no mandatory retirement age unless required by law. An employee intending to retire gives written notice per resignation procedures; statutory entitlements are processed through the relevant national system.

Abandonment of Employment

Where an employee is absent without authorization or contact for a continuous period defined by local law or policy (and despite reasonable attempts to contact them), the employment may be treated as abandoned and terminated in accordance with applicable law and a fair process, including written notice to the employee's last known address.

Termination for Performance or Misconduct

Termination for performance or misconduct follows the Discipline and Investigations procedures and applicable law, with the employee afforded due process, including the opportunity to respond.

Redundancy Procedure

- Redundancy may arise from funding reductions or donor constraints, program closure or restructuring, or organizational realignment;
- INARA follows applicable legal requirements on consultation and notification, applies fair and objective selection criteria, and considers redeployment alternatives where feasible;
- Affected employees receive appropriate notice and any statutory redundancy entitlements under local law, and reasonable support during transition.

Medical Incapacity

Where prolonged illness, injury, or disability prevents an employee performing their duties, INARA makes reasonable efforts to support the employee (adjustments, reassignment, extended leave) before considering termination, which is only in accordance with applicable law.

End of Fixed-Term Contract

Fixed-term employment ends per the contract and applicable law; renewal depends on need, performance, and funding.

Final Payments

- **Final salary:** all earned salary and entitlements up to the termination date.
- **Accrued leave:** accrued unused leave compensated per local law and policy.
- **Statutory entitlements on separation:** any statutory end-of-service entitlement is determined solely by applicable local law and the contract, and is addressed through the annex and/or the national social-security system.
- **Death of an employee:** outstanding payments and benefits are processed per law and transferred to the legally recognized beneficiary or estate.

Exit Clearance and Recovery of Property

- Departing employees complete the exit-clearance process: full handover of responsibilities, files, and tasks; settlement of outstanding obligations; and an exit interview where applicable;
- Employees must return all INARA property — equipment, devices, documents, identification, keys, and access credentials — and securely transfer or delete work data;
- System and email access is revoked by the last day; INARA may withhold final settlement pending return of property only where permitted by law.

Settlement Agreements

Where lawful and appropriate, INARA and an employee may enter a written settlement agreement to resolve the end of employment or a dispute on agreed terms, with independent advice where required by local law. Settlement agreements are reviewed by counsel and must comply with local legal requirements; they do not waive non-waivable statutory rights or protected disclosures.

Employment References

INARA provides employment verification per law and policy; unless otherwise authorized, this is limited to dates of employment and position held. Requests are handled through HR.

27. Legal Protection of INARA

Delegation of Authority and Contractual Limits

Employees may bind or commit INARA or an Employing Entity only within their delegated authority and the approved delegation-of-authority / financial-authority matrix. No employee may enter, vary, or authorize a contract, payment, or obligation beyond their authority. Commitments must be documented in writing and follow approval procedures. Acting beyond delegated authority is a disciplinary matter, and the individual may be personally responsible to the extent permitted by law.

Litigation and Claims Cooperation

Employees and former employees must cooperate reasonably with INARA in connection with claims, litigation, regulatory matters, or disputes relating to their employment or duties, including providing truthful information and reasonable assistance, subject to law and their own legal rights.

Audit Cooperation

Employees must cooperate fully with internal audits and with donor, statutory, and external audits, providing accurate information and access to records within their responsibility, and must not obstruct or mislead an audit.

Record Preservation (Litigation and Investigation Holds)

Where litigation, an investigation, a complaint or grievance, a safeguarding matter, a donor or compliance review, or an audit is reasonably anticipated or underway, relevant records and data must be preserved and must not be deleted, altered, or destroyed, notwithstanding ordinary retention schedules, until the hold is lifted by an authorized person. Failure to preserve records is a serious disciplinary matter.

Confidentiality After Employment

Confidentiality obligations continue after employment ends. Former employees must not use or disclose INARA's confidential, proprietary, beneficiary, donor, or personal information, and must not retain INARA materials. This does not prevent lawful protected disclosures (for example, genuine whistleblowing) or disclosures required by law.

Non-Disparagement

Subject to local law, employees and former employees are expected not to make false or malicious statements intended to damage INARA's reputation. This provision does not restrict honest opinion, lawful protected disclosures, whistleblowing, reports to regulators or authorities, evidence in legal proceedings, or any statement that cannot lawfully be restricted; it is unenforceable to the extent prohibited by local law.

28. Governance and Organizational Protection

Duty to Cooperate

All personnel have a duty to cooperate fully and honestly with audits, investigations, reviews, and compliance processes, to provide accurate information, and to preserve and not obstruct access to relevant records.

Board Reporting and Escalation

- **Board reporting channels:** concerns involving senior management, the CEO, or matters that cannot be resolved internally may be escalated to the Board or a Board-designated committee through the independent reporting route (Section 21).
- **Escalation framework:** matters are escalated based on severity and risk — from supervisor, to Country Director, to senior management, to the Board — with safeguarding, fraud, and serious security incidents escalated promptly.

Delegation Framework

Financial and operational authority is governed by the approved delegation-of-authority / financial-authority matrix, which defines approval thresholds and who may commit INARA. Employees must act within it (see Section 27).

Policy Exception Process

- Any deviation from this Handbook or its procedures requires prior approval;
- Exceptions are approved by an appropriate authority (HR and/or Senior Management, depending on the matter) and documented, with the reason, scope, duration, and any conditions recorded;
- Exceptions are time-limited and reviewed; they do not create a precedent or entitlement.

29. Employee Handbook Acknowledgement

This acknowledgement confirms the employee’s understanding of, and agreement to comply with, this Handbook. A signed copy is retained on the personnel file. (See also Appendix A.)

- I will perform my duties and comply with all INARA policies, the Code of Conduct, the PSEA Policy, the Child and Vulnerable Adult Protection Policy, and the Ethical Concerns and Duty to Report Policy.
- I will keep confidential all restricted or confidential information during and, where lawful, after my employment, and will not use it for personal gain or to INARA’s detriment.
- I understand that INARA systems and communications are INARA property and may be monitored and accessed in accordance with law and the data-protection policy.
- I will commit INARA only within my delegated authority and approved procedures.
- I understand this Handbook is incorporated into my contract by reference, subject to mandatory law and to my contract, which prevails in the event of conflict; that discretionary provisions are non-contractual and may change; and that INARA may amend the Handbook with notice.
- I certify that I have read, understood, and agree to comply with this Handbook.

Print Name	Signature	Date

COUNTRY-SPECIFIC ANNEXES

A — Egypt | B — Türkiye | C — Lebanon | D — Afghanistan | E — Palestine | F — Syria | G — Ukraine

IMPORTANT

How to read the annexes. Each annex adapts the Global Handbook to local law and prevails over the Handbook where local law requires. In each country the locally registered Employing Entity is the employer. The statutory figures (hours, leave, notice, contributions, end-of-service) reflect the law as compiled for this edition and must be confirmed against current law by local counsel before being relied on. Where an annex is silent, the Global Handbook applies.

Annex A — Egypt

Employer identity: The employer of personnel in this country is the locally registered Employing Entity, which concludes contracts, runs payroll, registers staff with the relevant authorities, and holds statutory employment liability. INARA International acts as parent/grantor and is not the employer and not a party to local employment contracts; INARA standards apply through the contract and the partnership agreement.

Verification note: *The statutory figures in this annex reflect Egyptian law as compiled for this edition and must be verified against current law and implementing regulations by local counsel before being relied upon. Any change must be notified to HR.*

1. Legal Framework and Applicability

Employment in Egypt is governed by Labour Law No. 14 of 2025 (in force from 1 September 2025, replacing Law No. 12 of 2003), together with the Social Insurance and Pensions Law No. 148 of 2019, occupational-safety regulations, and implementing decrees. This annex supplements the Global Handbook; Egyptian law prevails where it differs.

These provisions supplement the Global Handbook and address only matters where local law differs from or adds to it. Where differences arise, Egyptian labour law prevails. Where Egyptian labour law gives greater protection or benefit, the more favourable provision applies; where INARA policy gives greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply.

NOTE

Law No. 14 of 2025 is a comprehensive reform. Several figures changed from the previous law (annual leave, maternity leave, resignation notice, the overtime-authorization regime), and new obligations were introduced (four contract copies, a mandatory periodic pay increase, five-year record retention, and specialized labour courts). Confirm all figures with Egyptian counsel before reliance.

2. Employment Categories and Contracts

Contract type	Description	Key legal notes
Indefinite (open-ended)	Standard contract with no fixed end date	Default type; greatest job protection

Contract type	Description	Key legal notes
Fixed-term	Defined start and end date	Must be in writing; if work continues beyond the term it may become indefinite
Task-based / project	Linked to a specific task or project	Ends on completion of the defined task

- Contracts are written in Arabic and issued in four copies (employer, employee, the social-insurance authority, and the competent labour office); electronic signature is permitted;
- Each contract states role, wage, working hours, and conditions; employee records are retained for at least five years;
- Any change to terms must be documented and agreed.

3. Probation Period

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum	Up to 3 months	Cannot be extended beyond 3 months
Repetition	Not permitted for the same employer	Even on change of role or department
Contract requirement	Must be stated in the contract	If not stated, probation cannot be enforced
Termination in probation	Permitted by either party	Subject to good-faith principles
Confirmation	Automatic on completion	No new contract needed

4. Working Hours and Workweek

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum hours	48 hours per week	Typically 8 hours/day over 6 days
Daily hours	Up to 8 hours/day	May vary with operational need
Rest breaks	At least 1 hour/day	Not counted as working time
Continuous work	No more than 5 consecutive hours	Break required after this
Weekly rest	Minimum 24 consecutive hours	Usually Friday
Women's working hours	Generally scheduled 07:00–19:00	Subject to legal exceptions

In humanitarian or emergency contexts flexibility may be required, but legal limits and overtime compensation must be respected.

5. Overtime and Compensation

Type of work	Compensation	Key notes
Daytime overtime	Premium over the normal hourly wage	Rate set by the 2025 law and decrees — confirm current rate
Night overtime	Higher premium than daytime	Night work defined by law
Rest-day work	Compensatory rest day or additional pay	Must be documented
Public-holiday work	Premium pay plus compensatory day	Both elements typically required

Type of work	Compensation	Key notes
Authorization	Post-notification to the Ministry of Manpower within 7 days	Replaces the prior prior-authorization regime

All overtime is pre-approved by the supervisor, recorded, and calculated on the regular wage; it must not exceed legal limits.

6. Public Holidays

Employees are entitled to the official public holidays announced annually by the Government of Egypt. Work on a public holiday, where operationally required, is compensated under the law (premium pay and/or compensatory day). Religious holidays may follow the lunar calendar and be confirmed by official announcement.

7. Leave Entitlements

Annual Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Year 1	15 days	First year of service
From year 2	21 days	Standard entitlement
10+ years or age 50+	30 days	Higher entitlement
Employees with disabilities	45 days	Enhanced entitlement under the 2025 law
Waiver / payment in lieu	Cannot be waived; paid in lieu on termination	For accrued unused leave

Sick Leave

Sick leave is provided subject to medical certification and administered through the social-insurance system, with pay tiered by duration (commonly a higher rate for an initial period, then reduced). The employer may request verification; abuse may lead to disciplinary action.

Maternity and Parental Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maternity leave	120 days, paid	Up to three times during service
Nursing breaks	Two breaks per day	For 24 months after return
Job protection	Protected during maternity	Dismissal on maternity grounds prohibited
Paternity leave	Confirm under the 2025 law	May be granted under INARA policy where not statutory

Other Statutory Leave

Leave type	Entitlement	Key notes
Hajj leave	Up to 1 month, once during service	After required service period
Casual leave	Typically up to 6 days/year	Short-term personal leave

Leave type	Entitlement	Key notes
Official / civic duty	As mandated by law	Public and national duties

8. Wages, Payroll, and Social Contributions

- Employees are paid per contract and law; the private-sector minimum wage is set by the National Wages Council (reported at EGP 7,000/month in 2025) — confirm the current figure;
- All eligible employees are registered with the National Social Insurance Authority; employer and employee contributions are calculated and remitted per law;
- Law No. 14 of 2025 introduces a mandatory periodic (annual) pay increase tied to the social-insurance/contribution wage — confirm the current rate (reported at not less than 3%) and base with counsel;
- Payroll records and deductions are maintained for compliance and audit (records retained at least five years).

9. Benefits and Insurance

Eligible employees are covered under the Egyptian social-insurance system (pension, disability, work-injury, and related protections). Any additional benefits INARA provides (such as private health insurance) are subject to organizational policy, funding, and operational considerations. Where local mandatory law requires a benefit, that obligation applies regardless of general policy.

10. Termination and Notice Periods

Scenario	Requirement	Key notes
Resignation notice	3 months	Updated under the 2025 law
Fixed-term early termination by employer	Compensation (commonly 1 month's salary per year of service)	Confirm under the 2025 law
Probation	Per contract terms	Subject to good faith
Misconduct	Per legal grounds and due process	Disciplinary procedure followed except for defined gross misconduct

Termination must rest on a valid, justified reason with due process; arbitrary or unjustified termination may attract liability, decided by the specialized labour courts (operational from 1 October 2025).

11. Statutory End-of-Service Entitlements

LEGAL PROTECTION

No INARA severance schedule. End-of-service and any statutory severance are governed solely by Egyptian law and, where applicable, the national social-insurance system. INARA does not set its own severance formula; the statutory position below is descriptive and must be confirmed with local counsel.

- Employees covered by social insurance receive benefits through that system (pension, disability, and related entitlements);

- On any separation, final dues (earned salary, accrued unused leave, and legal entitlements) are paid;
- Where termination is found unjustified, compensation may be awarded by the labour courts.

12. Disciplinary and Labour Compliance

Disciplinary action is based on documented violations and follows due process: the employee is informed of allegations and given an opportunity to respond; sanctions are proportionate; termination for misconduct follows legally defined grounds and procedures. Disciplinary records are maintained as required by law and must align with the Handbook's discipline procedure (Section 23).

13. Health, Safety, and Working Conditions

INARA complies with Egyptian occupational-health-and-safety regulations: a safe environment, safety measures and training, risk assessment and mitigation, and reporting and management of work-related injuries and incidents. Employees must follow safety procedures and report hazards.

14. Equality, Non-Discrimination, and Worker Protection

INARA provides equal employment opportunity, prevents discrimination and harassment, and ensures fair treatment in accordance with law. Specific legal protections (including those relating to gender, disability, and other protected characteristics) are respected and applied.

15. Special Provisions

Provision	Requirement	Key notes
Employment of women	Protected under labour law	Maternity protection and workplace safeguards
Employment of minors	Restricted and regulated	Minimum age and conditions apply
Hajj leave	Up to 1 month, once	Subject to eligibility
Workplace documentation	Mandatory records	Contracts, payroll, personnel files; 5-year retention

Statutory Compliance Summary

Area	Position (verify locally)
Social security	Mandatory registration with the National Social Insurance Authority; employer and employee contributions remitted per law.
Tax	Income tax withheld and remitted under Egyptian tax law.
Mandatory insurance	Social-insurance coverage (pension, disability, work-injury).
Trade union rights	Freedom of association and union rights recognized under Egyptian law.
Grievance	Internal grievance per policy; statutory recourse to the labour authorities/courts.
Discipline	Documented violations, right to respond, proportionate sanctions; structured framework under the 2025 law.

Area	Position (verify locally)
Redundancy	Permitted on lawful economic/operational grounds; statutory entitlements per law.
Occupational safety	Egyptian OHS regulations; risk mitigation; accident/illness reporting above the legal threshold.
Safeguarding reporting	National (and, where relevant, international) child-protection reporting obligations apply.
Court jurisdiction	Specialized labour courts (operational from October 2025) decide employment disputes within statutory timelines.
Mandatory protections	Anti-discrimination, anti-harassment; protections for women and minors; mandatory periodic pay increase.

Governing Law and Conflict of Provisions

This annex is governed by the laws of the Arab Republic of Egypt. In the event of conflict between the Global Handbook, this annex, and Egyptian labour law, Egyptian labour law prevails. Where INARA policy provides greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply. This annex must be read with the Global Handbook and all related policies.

Annex B — Türkiye

Employer identity: The employer of personnel in this country is the locally registered Employing Entity, which concludes contracts, runs payroll, registers staff with the relevant authorities, and holds statutory employment liability. INARA International acts as parent/grantor and is not the employer and not a party to local employment contracts; INARA standards apply through the contract and the partnership agreement.

Verification note: *The statutory figures in this annex reflect Turkish law as compiled for this edition and must be verified against current law and implementing regulations by local counsel before being relied upon. Any change must be notified to HR.*

1. Legal Framework and Applicability

Employment in Türkiye is governed by Labour Law No. 4857, Social Security Law No. 5510, and Occupational Health and Safety Law No. 6331, together with related regulations. This annex supplements the Global Handbook; Turkish law prevails where it differs.

These provisions supplement the Global Handbook and address only matters where local law differs from or adds to it. Where differences arise, Turkish labour law prevails. Where Turkish labour law gives greater protection or benefit, the more favourable provision applies; where INARA policy gives greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply.

2. Employment Categories and Contracts

Contract type	Description	Key notes
Indefinite (open-ended)	No fixed end date	Default and most common form
Fixed-term	Defined start and end date	Only with objective justification (e.g., project work)
Part-time	Fewer hours than full-time	Rights/benefits proportionate; must not be treated less favourably
Temporary / project-based	Linked to a project or duration	Must comply with fixed-term rules

- A written contract is mandatory where employment exceeds one year; contracts are in Turkish for legal validity and define role, salary, and conditions;
- Repeated fixed-term contracts without valid justification may be deemed indefinite;
- Any change to terms must be documented and agreed.

3. Probation Period

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum	Up to 2 months	May extend to 4 months by collective agreement
Contract requirement	Must be agreed in writing	If not specified, cannot be applied
Termination in probation	Permitted by either party	No notice required
Pay/benefits	Full salary and benefits apply	All legal rights retained

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Social security	Mandatory from day one	SGK registration before/on first day

4. Working Hours and Workweek

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum hours	45 hours per week	Standard full-time limit
Distribution	Spread over working days	Typically 5–6 days
Overtime threshold	Beyond 45 hours/week	Triggers overtime
Annual overtime cap	270 hours per year	Legal maximum
Daily rest	Minimum 11 consecutive hours	Between workdays
Weekly rest	Minimum 24 consecutive hours	Typically Sunday

5. Overtime and Compensation

Type of work	Compensation	Key notes
Overtime (beyond 45 hrs/week)	At least 150% of the normal hourly wage	Or equivalent time off where agreed
Rest-day / holiday work	Additional pay or compensatory rest	Must be documented
Limits	Within legal maxima	Annual cap 270 hours

Overtime is pre-approved, recorded, and calculated on the regular wage.

6. Public Holidays

Employees are entitled to official national and religious public holidays announced annually. Work on a public holiday is compensated with an additional day's wage; religious holidays follow the lunar calendar and official confirmation.

7. Leave Entitlements

Annual Leave

Service	Entitlement	Key notes
1–5 years	14 days	After 1 year of service
5–15 years	20 days	
15+ years	26 days	
Under 18 or over 50	20 days minimum	Regardless of service
Continuous block	At least 10 consecutive days on request	Mandatory if requested

Sick Leave

Sick leave is based on an official medical report; SGK pays after an initial period, and the employer may cover initial days per policy. Employment is protected during valid sick leave subject to legal limits.

Maternity and Paternity Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maternity leave	16 weeks (8 before + 8 after birth)	Paid through SGK
Multiple pregnancy	+2 weeks before birth	Total 18 weeks
Paternity leave	5 days, paid	On birth of a child
Additional unpaid leave	Up to 6 months	Optional, on request

Other Statutory Leave

Leave type	Entitlement	Key notes
Marriage leave	3 days, paid	
Bereavement leave	3 days	Close family members
Adoption leave	Similar to maternity provisions	Subject to conditions
Unpaid leave	Permitted	Subject to approval and law

8. Wages, Payroll, and Social Contributions

- Minimum wage is set by the government and updated annually; salaries are paid monthly in Turkish Lira, typically by bank transfer, with payslips;
- SGK registration is mandatory before or on the first working day; employer and employee contributions are at statutory rates, with monthly declarations;
- SGK covers pension, health, disability, and work injury; unemployment-insurance contributions also apply.

9. Benefits and Insurance

All eligible employees are covered under SGK (health, pension, disability, work injury) and unemployment insurance. INARA may provide supplementary benefits (e.g., private health insurance) subject to policy, funding, and operational considerations.

10. Termination and Notice Periods

Service	Minimum notice	Key notes
Less than 6 months	2 weeks	Applies to both parties
6 months – 1.5 years	4 weeks	
1.5 – 3 years	6 weeks	
More than 3 years	8 weeks	Maximum statutory notice

- Pay in lieu of notice is permitted; notice does not apply during probation;
- Job-security protections apply to employees with 6+ months' service in workplaces with 30+ employees; termination must rest on a valid reason with written notification, and may be challenged, with possible reinstatement;
- Employees are entitled to time off to seek work during notice.

11. Statutory End-of-Service (Severance) Entitlements

LEGAL PROTECTION

No INARA severance schedule. End-of-service and any statutory severance are governed solely by Turkish law and, where applicable, the national social-insurance system. INARA does not set its own severance formula; the statutory position below is descriptive and must be confirmed with local counsel.

Turkish law provides statutory severance pay (kıdem tazminatı): broadly, employees with at least one year of continuous service are entitled, on qualifying termination (including employer termination not based on the employee's serious misconduct, and certain qualifying resignations such as retirement or military service), to severance calculated by law (commonly one month's gross salary per year of service, subject to the statutory ceiling updated periodically). Severance is not payable on dismissal for serious misconduct. The exact entitlement and ceiling must be confirmed with Turkish counsel; INARA does not set a separate formula.

12. Disciplinary and Labour Compliance

Disciplinary action rests on valid grounds and documented evidence; a written defence is obtained from the employee before sanctions that may lead to termination; termination for misconduct follows legally defined just causes and procedure, with written notification. All action aligns with the Handbook's discipline procedure (Section 23).

13. Health, Safety, and Working Conditions

Under Law No. 6331, INARA ensures a safe workplace, risk assessments, OHS training, preventive and protective measures, OHS services (workplace physician and safety specialist where required), and reporting of accidents within legal timelines. Employees follow safety procedures, use equipment properly, and report hazards.

14. Equality, Non-Discrimination, and Worker Protection

Employees are treated equally regardless of protected characteristics; equal pay for equal work applies; discrimination in recruitment, conditions, promotion, and termination is prohibited; harassment and unfair treatment are prohibited, with compensation available where discrimination is established.

15. Special Provisions

Provision	Requirement	Key notes
Employment of women	Protected	Maternity protections; restrictions on certain hazardous work
Employment of minors	Strictly regulated	Minimum age and conditions
Night work	Restricted	Additional protections for women and young workers
Annual-leave continuity	10 consecutive days on request	Legal requirement

Provision	Requirement	Key notes
Job security	30+ employee workplaces, 6+ months service	Valid-reason and reinstatement regime

Statutory Compliance Summary

Area	Position (verify locally)
Social security	Mandatory SGK registration before/on first day; contributions at statutory rates with monthly declarations.
Tax	Income tax withheld and remitted under Turkish tax law.
Mandatory insurance	SGK: health, pension, disability, work-injury; unemployment insurance.
Trade union rights	Recognized under the Trade Unions and Collective Labour Agreements Law (No. 6356).
Grievance	Internal grievance per policy; statutory recourse via labour courts.
Discipline	Documented grounds; written defence required before sanctions that may lead to termination.
Redundancy	Job-security and valid-reason requirements; severance/notice per law.
Occupational safety	Law No. 6331: risk assessments, OHS services/training, accident reporting within legal timelines.
Safeguarding reporting	National child-protection reporting obligations apply.
Court jurisdiction	Turkish labour courts; mandatory pre-litigation mediation for most employment claims.
Mandatory protections	Equal treatment and equal pay; protections for women, minors, and night workers; statutory severance.

Governing Law and Conflict of Provisions

This annex is governed by the laws of the Republic of Türkiye. In the event of conflict between the Global Handbook, this annex, and Turkish labour law, Turkish labour law prevails. Where INARA policy provides greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply. This annex must be read with the Global Handbook and all related policies.

Annex C — Lebanon

Employer identity: The employer of personnel in this country is the locally registered Employing Entity (for example, HCWW), which concludes contracts, runs payroll, registers staff with the relevant authorities, and holds statutory employment liability. INARA International acts as parent/grantor and is not the employer and not a party to local employment contracts; INARA standards apply through the contract and the partnership agreement.

Verification note: *The statutory figures in this annex reflect Lebanese law as compiled for this edition and must be verified against current law and implementing regulations by local counsel before being relied upon. Any change must be notified to HR.*

1. Legal Framework and Applicability

Employment in Lebanon is governed by the Lebanese Labour Law of 1946 (as amended) and National Social Security Fund (NSSF) regulations. This annex supplements the Global Handbook; Lebanese law prevails where it differs.

These provisions supplement the Global Handbook and address only matters where local law differs from or adds to it. Where differences arise, Lebanese labour law prevails. Where Lebanese labour law gives greater protection or benefit, the more favourable provision applies; where INARA policy gives greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply.

IMPORTANT

Separate contracts. In Lebanon, separate employment agreements are used for INARA-standard purposes and for the local Employing Entity (for example, HCWW). The Employing Entity is the legal employer for Lebanese-law purposes. Keep the contracting structure consistent with counsel's advice to preserve the employer model.

2. Employment Categories and Contracts

Contract type	Description	Key notes
Indefinite (open-ended)	No fixed end date	Most common; presumed where no written contract exists
Fixed-term	Defined duration	Beyond two years, or on repeated renewal, may be deemed open-ended
Project-based / task	Linked to a specific task	Ends on completion
Part-time	Reduced hours	Rights/benefits proportionate
Daily labour	Daily worker	NSSF registration applies if work exceeds 10 days/month

- Written contracts are strongly advised; the agreement is drafted in Arabic (bilingual permitted) and defines title, role, salary, and conditions;
- A signed job description should be held for each employee;
- Any change to terms must be documented and agreed.

3. Probation Period

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum	Typically up to 3 months	Must be stated in the contract
Termination in probation	Permitted by either party	Generally without notice or indemnity; good faith applies
Pay	Full salary	Basic rights retained

4. Working Hours and Workweek

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum hours	48 hours per week	Standard full-time
Daily hours	Typically 8 hours/day	May vary
Weekly rest	At least one full day (minimum 24 consecutive hours, commonly 36)	Usually Sunday
Rest breaks	During the workday	Per work conditions

5. Overtime and Compensation

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Threshold	Work beyond 48 hours/week	Triggers overtime
Rest-day work	Additional pay or compensatory rest	Agreed and documented
Public-holiday work	Additional compensation	Agreed and documented

Overtime is pre-approved, recorded, and compensated per law; compensatory time off may be granted by agreement.

6. Public Holidays

Lebanon recognizes a wide range of national and religious public holidays across different religious communities, announced annually. Work on a public holiday, where operationally required, is compensated by additional pay or compensatory leave.

7. Leave Entitlements

Annual Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Entitlement	Minimum 15 days/year	After 1 year of continuous service
Carry-over	Limited	Subject to employer approval
Payment in lieu	Permitted on termination	For accrued unused leave

Sick Leave

Sick leave is provided per Article 40 of the Labour Law, with tiered pay by service duration, subject to medical certification; the employer may request verification.

Maternity and Paternity Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maternity leave	10 weeks, paid	Protected from dismissal during leave
Paternity leave	Not statutory	May be granted under INARA policy

Other Leave

Leave type	Entitlement	Key notes
Marriage leave	Typically 3 days	Common practice
Bereavement leave	Typically 2–3 days	Depends on relationship
Unpaid leave	Permitted	Subject to approval

8. Wages, Payroll, and Social Contributions

- Minimum wage is set by government decree and revised periodically; salaries are paid regularly (typically monthly), with payroll records maintained for audit;
- Eligible employees are registered with the NSSF; employer and employee contributions are at statutory rates with periodic declarations;
- NSSF covers health, family allowances, end-of-service indemnity, and work injury.

9. Benefits and Insurance

Eligible employees are covered through the NSSF (health, family allowances, end-of-service indemnity, work-injury). INARA may provide supplementary benefits subject to policy, funding, and operational considerations.

10. Termination and Notice Periods

Service	Minimum notice	Key notes
Less than 3 years	1 month	Applies to both parties
3 – 6 years	2 months	Applies to both parties
6 – 12 years	3 months	Applies to both parties
More than 12 years	4 months	Maximum statutory notice

- Pay in lieu of notice is permitted; notice does not apply for serious misconduct under Article 74;
- Employees are entitled to reasonable time (about one hour/day) to seek new employment during notice;
- Termination must be in good faith and not abusive or arbitrary; unjustified or abusive dismissal may attract compensation awarded by the labour authorities.

11. Statutory End-of-Service Entitlements

LEGAL PROTECTION

No INARA severance schedule. End-of-service and any statutory severance are governed solely by Lebanese law and, where applicable, the national social-insurance system. INARA does not set its own severance formula; the statutory position below is descriptive and must be confirmed with local counsel.

- End-of-service indemnity (EOSI) is accumulated through employer contributions to the NSSF during service and paid through the NSSF on qualifying termination;
- Failure to register employees with the NSSF may result in direct employer liability for the indemnity;
- On separation, final dues (earned salary, accrued leave) are paid; disputes may be referred to the labour authorities.

12. Disciplinary and Labour Compliance

Lebanese law does not prescribe a detailed disciplinary procedure, but requires good faith: disciplinary action rests on valid, documented grounds; the employee is informed and given an opportunity to respond; sanctions are proportionate; termination for misconduct is justified and documented. All action aligns with the Handbook's discipline procedure (Section 23).

13. Health, Safety, and Working Conditions

INARA provides a safe working environment, takes reasonable measures to prevent risks, informs employees of basic health-and-safety requirements, and reports and manages work-related incidents. Employees follow safety instructions and report hazards.

14. Equality, Non-Discrimination, and Worker Protection

INARA provides equal opportunity, prevents discrimination and harassment, and ensures fair treatment in recruitment, conditions, promotion, and termination, applying its internal standards above the general statutory baseline.

15. Special Provisions

Provision	Requirement	Key notes
Employment of women	Protected	Maternity protections
Employment of minors	Regulated	Minimum age and conditions
Multi-religious context	Recognized	Affects holidays and leave
Work permits (foreign staff)	Mandatory	Required for non-Lebanese employees

Statutory Compliance Summary

Area	Position (verify locally)
Social security	NSSF registration mandatory for eligible employees; contributions at statutory rates with periodic declarations.

Area	Position (verify locally)
Tax	Income tax withheld and remitted under Lebanese tax law.
Mandatory insurance	NSSF: health, family allowances, end-of-service indemnity, work-injury.
Trade union rights	Freedom of association and union rights recognized.
Grievance	Internal grievance per policy; recourse to the labour authorities.
Discipline	Good-faith, documented, proportionate; opportunity to respond; not arbitrary or abusive.
Redundancy	Permitted on lawful grounds; protection against abusive dismissal.
Occupational safety	General OHS duties; safe environment and incident reporting.
Safeguarding reporting	National child-protection reporting obligations apply.
Court jurisdiction	Lebanese labour arbitration councils / competent labour courts.
Mandatory protections	Protections for women and minors; work permits for foreign employees; non-waivable statutory rights.

Governing Law and Conflict of Provisions

This annex is governed by the laws of the Lebanese Republic. In the event of conflict between the Global Handbook, this annex, and Lebanese labour law, Lebanese labour law prevails. Where INARA policy provides greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply. This annex must be read with the Global Handbook and all related policies.

Annex D — Afghanistan

Employer identity: The employer of personnel in this country is the locally registered Employing Entity, which concludes contracts, runs payroll, registers staff with the relevant authorities, and holds statutory employment liability. INARA International acts as parent/grantor and is not the employer and not a party to local employment contracts; INARA standards apply through the contract and the partnership agreement.

Verification note: *The statutory figures in this annex reflect Afghan law as compiled for this edition and must be verified against current law and implementing regulations by local counsel before being relied upon. Any change must be notified to HR.*

CAUTION

Evolving legal environment. Afghanistan's legal and administrative environment is changing, and the status and enforcement of the labour framework under the de facto authorities is uncertain. Treat the figures below as indicative; confirm the current position with in-country counsel before relying on them, and apply the provision that best ensures compliance, staff protection, and continuity while adhering to humanitarian principles.

1. Legal Framework and Applicability

Employment in Afghanistan is governed by the Afghan Labour Law (2007) and applicable regulations and administrative requirements. Implementation may be subject to interpretation and practical constraints. INARA complies to the extent possible while ensuring alignment with its policies, donor requirements, and humanitarian principles; where instruments conflict, INARA applies the provision that best ensures legal compliance, operational continuity, and protection of employees.

These provisions supplement the Global Handbook and address only matters where local law differs from or adds to it. Where differences arise, applicable Afghan law and administrative practice prevails. Where applicable Afghan law and administrative practice gives greater protection or benefit, the more favourable provision applies; where INARA policy gives greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply.

2. Employment Categories and Contracts

Contract type	Description	Key notes
Indefinite (open-ended)	No fixed end date	Common for long-term positions
Fixed-term	Specified period	Frequent in NGO/project roles
Project-based	Linked to donor-funded projects	May end on project completion or funding change
Part-time / casual	Reduced or irregular hours	Per operational need

- Written contracts are strongly recommended, in Dari, Pashto, or bilingual, understandable to the employee, defining role, salary, duration, and conditions;

- Documentation is important for compliance and donor audit; continuity may depend on program duration and funding.

3. Probation Period

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum	Per Article 17 (commonly up to 3 months)	Confirm current application; must be stated in the contract
Termination in probation	Permitted by either party	Generally without notice or severance
Pay	Full salary	Basic rights retained

4. Working Hours and Workweek

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Standard hours	40 hours per week	Typically 8 hours/day
Workweek	Usually Sunday–Thursday	May vary by context
Weekly rest	At least 1 day (typically Friday)	Mandatory
Ramadan	Reduced/adjusted hours	Per local practice

5. Overtime and Compensation

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Overtime rate	25% premium for the first 2 hours; 50% thereafter	Premium over regular wage
Rest-day / holiday work	100% premium (double pay) or compensatory day	Agreed and documented
Limits	Not exceeding ~4 hours over 2 consecutive days	Excessive overtime avoided

6. Public Holidays

Public holidays follow national events and the Islamic calendar, per official announcement; dates may vary annually. Work on a public holiday, where required, is compensated by additional pay or compensatory leave.

7. Leave Entitlements

Annual Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Entitlement	Minimum 20 days/year	After 1 year of service
Carry-over	Limited	Subject to operational approval
Payment in lieu	Permitted on termination	For unused leave

Sick Leave

Up to 20 days of paid sick leave per year, subject to medical certification; verification may be requested for extended absence.

Maternity and Paternity Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maternity leave	Minimum 90 days, paid	Protected from dismissal
Paternity leave	Not clearly defined	May be granted under INARA policy / covered by necessary leave

Other Leave

Leave type	Entitlement	Key notes
Necessary leave	10 days/year	Urgent personal matters (covers marriage, paternity, bereavement)
Hajj leave	45 days, paid, once in a lifetime	Subject to eligibility
Unpaid leave	Permitted	After annual and necessary leave exhausted

8. Wages, Payroll, and Social Contributions

- Minimum wage is set by the authorities and may be revised; salaries are paid regularly (typically monthly), with payroll records maintained for audit and donor compliance;
- Income tax is withheld and remitted by the employer per applicable rules;
- There is no comprehensive national social-security system; protections are provided directly by the Employing Entity per contract and law.

9. Benefits and Insurance

With no comprehensive national social-security system, INARA may provide benefits such as health coverage or allowances subject to feasibility and funding; workplace-injury coverage is an employer duty of care; end-of-service is provided by the employer per the Labour Law. Enhanced protections may apply in high-risk environments under INARA's duty of care.

10. Termination and Notice Periods

Contract type	Typical notice	Key notes
Indefinite	1 month	Standard practice
Fixed-term	Per contract	May end at expiry
Probation	No or minimal notice	Per contract
Project-based	Linked to project/funding	May end on completion

Pay in lieu of notice may apply where immediate termination is required; termination without notice may occur for serious misconduct, with documentation recommended.

11. Statutory End-of-Service Entitlements

LEGAL PROTECTION

No INARA severance schedule. End-of-service and any statutory severance are governed solely by Afghan law and, where applicable, the national social-insurance system. INARA does not set its own severance formula; the statutory position below is descriptive and must be confirmed with local counsel.

- Under the Afghan Labour Law (Article 25), end-of-service is paid by the employer (no central social-security system): commonly 1 month's salary for service up to 1 year and 2 months' salary for 1–5 years, with higher tiers for longer service;
- Payment is calculated on the employee's final salary and rank at termination; it may not apply in cases of misconduct;
- Accurate records of service and salary are essential; confirm current application with counsel.

12. Disciplinary and Labour Compliance

Disciplinary action rests on valid, documented grounds; the employee is informed and given an opportunity to respond; sanctions are proportionate; termination for misconduct is justified and documented. Processes balance legal requirements with practical and security considerations and align with the Handbook's discipline procedure (Section 23).

13. Health, Safety, and Working Conditions

INARA provides a safe and secure working environment, assesses and mitigates security and field risks, informs staff of safety procedures, and reports and manages incidents. Special consideration is given to security risks and operational constraints in high-risk environments.

14. Equality, Non-Discrimination, and Worker Protection

INARA promotes equality, dignity, and respect, provides equal opportunity to the extent possible within the operational context, prevents discrimination and harassment, and applies internal standards to ensure a higher level of protection, taking into account local laws and operational realities.

15. Special Provisions

Provision	Requirement	Key notes
Gender considerations	Subject to local regulations	May affect roles, presence, and interactions
Work permits (international staff)	Required	Comply with administrative authorities
Security constraints	Operational requirement	May affect mobility, hours, duty stations
NGO regulations	Applicable	Registration and operational compliance required

Statutory Compliance Summary

Area	Position (verify locally)
Social security	No centralized system; protections provided directly by the Employing Entity per contract and law.
Tax	Income tax / withholding per applicable rules.
Mandatory insurance	Limited; employer duty of care; provision per contract and donor requirements.
Trade union rights	Subject to the prevailing legal and administrative context.
Grievance	Internal grievance per policy; recourse subject to local context.
Discipline	Documented grounds, opportunity to respond; balances legal and security considerations.
Redundancy	Per contract and applicable law; often funding-driven in NGO operations.
Occupational safety	Employer duty of care; security-risk assessment and mitigation.
Safeguarding reporting	National obligations to the extent applicable, plus INARA safeguarding standards.
Court jurisdiction	Applicable Afghan legal/administrative framework.
Mandatory protections	Equality and dignity applied per INARA standards within the local context; statutory end-of-service (Article 25).

Governing Law and Conflict of Provisions

This annex is governed by the laws of Afghanistan. In the event of conflict between the Global Handbook, this annex, and applicable Afghan law and administrative practice, applicable Afghan law and administrative practice prevails. Where INARA policy provides greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply. This annex must be read with the Global Handbook and all related policies.

Annex E — Palestine

Employer identity: The employer of personnel in this country is the locally registered Employing Entity, which concludes contracts, runs payroll, registers staff with the relevant authorities, and holds statutory employment liability. INARA International acts as parent/grantor and is not the employer and not a party to local employment contracts; INARA standards apply through the contract and the partnership agreement.

Verification note: *The statutory figures in this annex reflect Palestinian law as compiled for this edition and must be verified against current law and implementing regulations by local counsel before being relied upon. Any change must be notified to HR.*

NOTE

Applies to the West Bank and Gaza Strip. The political, security, and administrative environment may affect implementation; where operational constraints arise, INARA applies the provision that best ensures legal compliance, staff protection, and continuity.

1. Legal Framework and Applicability

Employment in Palestine is governed primarily by the Palestinian Labour Law No. 7 of 2000 and applicable regulations. This annex supplements the Global Handbook; Palestinian law prevails where it differs, unless operational or humanitarian considerations require the provision that best ensures compliance, protection, and continuity.

These provisions supplement the Global Handbook and address only matters where local law differs from or adds to it. Where differences arise, Palestinian labour law prevails. Where Palestinian labour law gives greater protection or benefit, the more favourable provision applies; where INARA policy gives greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply.

2. Employment Categories and Contracts

Contract type	Description	Key notes
Indefinite	No fixed end date	Standard employment type
Fixed-term	Defined duration	Common in the NGO sector
Project-based	Linked to donor funding	Ends with project completion
Part-time	Reduced hours	Per operational need

Contracts are in writing (Arabic recommended) and must define wage, job type, location, duration, and benefits; documentation is critical for audit. Workers must perform duties honestly and follow workplace rules.

3. Probation Period

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum	3 months	As per law
Termination in probation	Permitted	Without notice

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Pay	Full salary	No reduction permitted

4. Working Hours and Workweek

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Weekly hours	45 hours	Standard under the law
Daily hours	8–9 hours	Depending on schedule
Weekly rest	1 day (usually Friday)	Mandatory
Ramadan	Reduced hours	Common practice

5. Overtime and Compensation

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Overtime rate	125% of normal wage	Minimum legal requirement
Rest-day work	150% or compensatory leave	
Public-holiday work	150% or compensatory leave	
Approval	Required and documented	

6. Public Holidays

Public holidays are declared by the Palestinian authorities and include national and religious (Islamic and Christian) holidays, with variable dates. Work on a public holiday requires compensation.

7. Leave Entitlements

Annual Leave

Service	Entitlement	Key notes
Less than 5 years	14 days	Paid; not accumulated beyond two years
5 years or more	21 days	Paid; not accumulated beyond two years

Sick Leave

Period	Pay rate	Key notes
First 14 days	100%	On certification
Next 14 days	50%	
Additional	Unpaid (if applicable)	

Maternity and Paternity Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maternity leave	10 weeks, paid	At least 6 weeks after delivery

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Breastfeeding hour	1 hour/day, paid	For one year from delivery
Protection	Mandatory	No dismissal allowed
Paternity leave	3 days, paid	

Other Leave

Leave type	Entitlement	Key notes
Marriage leave	3 days – one week	Not fully mandated
Bereavement leave	3 days	Mandatory
Hajj leave	Up to 2 weeks, once	Not fully mandated

8. Wages, Payroll, and Social Contributions

- Minimum wage is set by the competent authority (reported at NIS 1,880/month; subject to revision and currency conversion) — confirm current figure;
- Salaries are paid monthly; payroll records are maintained for audit;
- The national social-security system is limited; INARA implements measures to protect employees where coverage is limited.

9. Benefits and Insurance

Health insurance is commonly employer-provided (not fully mandated); work-injury cover is an employer duty of care; additional benefits are discretionary per NGO practice. Injured workers receive medical care and wage compensation (commonly 75% during temporary disability); permanent-disability or death compensation is based on wages; claims are generally filed within two years.

10. Termination and Notice Periods

Employment ends by mutual agreement, expiry of contract, resignation with notice, or death/incapacity. A worker may resign with full rights where the employer violates obligations or conditions become unsafe or unfair.

Contract type	Notice	Key notes
Indefinite (monthly paid)	1 month written notice	Clear and documented
Fixed-term	Ends at expiry; 1 month if ended early	Early termination needs a valid reason
Daily / weekly / piecework	1 week notice	

- The worker may be absent during the second half of the notice period, paid and counted as working time (Article 46);
- The employer may terminate without notice for fraud, serious negligence, repeated violations, absenteeism, or misconduct;
- Termination is arbitrary (unlawful) where no valid reason exists or legal procedures (such as notice) are not followed.

11. Statutory End-of-Service Entitlements

LEGAL PROTECTION

No INARA severance schedule. End-of-service and any statutory severance are governed solely by Palestinian law and, where applicable, the national social-insurance system. INARA does not set its own severance formula; the statutory position below is descriptive and must be confirmed with local counsel.

- End-of-service: 1 month's full wage for each year of service (Article 45), for employees who have completed at least one year of continuous service, on normal termination or qualifying resignation;
- Arbitrary dismissal: 2 months' full wage per year of service (subject to legal limits);
- Entitlements are forfeited in cases of legally proven gross misconduct; payment is due promptly on separation; accrued unused leave (not accumulated beyond two years) is also paid.

12. Disciplinary and Labour Compliance

Disciplinary action rests on valid, documented grounds; the employee is informed and given an opportunity to respond; sanctions are proportionate; termination for cause follows the law. All action aligns with the Handbook's discipline procedure (Section 23).

13. Health, Safety, and Working Conditions

INARA ensures safe working conditions, risk mitigation (especially in Gaza), medical care, and preventive measures; workers are not charged for safety provision. Employers must insure workers; injured workers receive medical care and wage compensation as above.

14. Equality, Non-Discrimination, and Worker Protection

INARA promotes equal opportunity, prevents discrimination and harassment, and applies higher internal standards. A statutory quota applies for employing workers with disabilities (not less than 5% of the workforce), and work permits are regulated for non-Palestinian employees.

15. Special Provisions

Workers cannot waive their legal rights, even by agreement; the law sets minimum standards and any agreement giving less protection is invalid; where multiple rules apply, the rule more favourable to the worker prevails.

Statutory Compliance Summary

Area	Position (verify locally)
Social security	National social-security system is limited; INARA implements protective measures where coverage is limited.
Tax	Income tax per the competent authority.

Area	Position (verify locally)
Mandatory insurance	Health insurance commonly employer-provided; work-injury an employer duty of care (worker insurance required).
Trade union rights	Freedom of association and union rights recognized.
Grievance	Internal grievance per policy; statutory recourse to labour authorities.
Discipline	Documented grounds; opportunity to respond; termination for cause per law.
Redundancy	Per law; arbitrary/unlawful dismissal attracts statutory compensation.
Occupational safety	OHS duties; worker insurance; injury compensation; claims within two years.
Safeguarding reporting	National child-protection reporting obligations apply.
Court jurisdiction	Palestinian labour courts / competent authorities.
Mandatory protections	Women (maternity, breastfeeding) and minors; 5% disability employment quota; non-waivable rights.

Governing Law and Conflict of Provisions

This annex is governed by the laws of Palestine. In the event of conflict between the Global Handbook, this annex, and Palestinian labour law, Palestinian labour law prevails. Where INARA policy provides greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply. This annex must be read with the Global Handbook and all related policies.

Annex F — Syria

Employer identity: The employer of personnel in this country is the locally registered Employing Entity, which concludes contracts, runs payroll, registers staff with the relevant authorities, and holds statutory employment liability. INARA International acts as parent/grantor and is not the employer and not a party to local employment contracts; INARA standards apply through the contract and the partnership agreement.

Verification note: *The statutory figures in this annex reflect Syrian law as compiled for this edition and must be verified against current law and implementing regulations by local counsel before being relied upon. Any change must be notified to HR.*

CAUTION

Political-currency risk. Following the change of government in late 2024, the applicability and enforcement of the prior legal framework (Labour Law No. 17 of 2010 and GOSI) is uncertain. Treat the figures below as indicative and confirm the current position with in-country counsel before relying on them.

1. Legal Framework and Applicability

Employment in Syria is governed by Syrian Labour Law No. 17 of 2010 and applicable social-insurance (GOSI), occupational-safety, and employment regulations. This annex supplements the Global Handbook; Syrian law prevails where it differs.

These provisions supplement the Global Handbook and address only matters where local law differs from or adds to it. Where differences arise, Syrian labour law prevails. Where Syrian labour law gives greater protection or benefit, the more favourable provision applies; where INARA policy gives greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply.

2. Employment Categories and Contracts

Contract type	Description	Key notes
Indefinite (open-ended)	No fixed end date	Standard form under Syrian law
Fixed-term	Defined duration	Must specify start/end; may be renewed
Project-based / task	Linked to a task or project	Ends on completion
Part-time	Reduced hours	Rights/benefits proportionate
Seasonal / temporary	Linked to periods or operational need	Duration must be defined

- Written contracts are required, in Arabic (bilingual permitted), signed by both parties and issued in multiple copies (employer, employee, and authorities where required);
- Indefinite is the default unless a fixed term is clearly justified; repeated renewals may create continuity expectations;
- Amendments must be documented and agreed.

3. Probation Period

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum	Up to 3 months	Must not exceed three months
Contract requirement	Must be stated	Otherwise unenforceable
Termination in probation	Permitted by either party	Generally without notice or severance
Pay	Full salary	Basic rights retained

4. Working Hours and Workweek

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maximum hours	48 hours per week	Standard full-time
Daily hours	Typically 8 hours/day	Per operational need
Weekly rest	Minimum 24 consecutive hours	Usually Friday
Ramadan / security	Adjusted hours	In line with law

5. Overtime and Compensation

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Overtime rate	At least 125% of the normal hourly wage	25% increase
Night work	Higher compensation may apply	Per regulation/policy
Rest-day / holiday work	Additional compensation or compensatory rest	Documented

6. Public Holidays

Syria recognizes national and religious (Islamic and Christian) holidays announced annually; lunar-calendar holidays vary each year. Work on a public holiday is compensated by additional pay or compensatory leave.

7. Leave Entitlements

Annual Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Entitlement	14 days/year (21 after 5 years)	By length of service
Accrual	After 1 year of service	May be prorated
Payment in lieu	Permitted on termination	For accrued unused leave

Sick Leave

Period	Pay rate	Key notes
First 90 days	70% of wage	Article 167-a; on certification
Next 90 days	80% of wage	Up to ~180 days/year total

Maternity and Paternity Leave

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Maternity (1st birth)	120 days, fully paid	After 6 months continuous service
Maternity (2nd birth)	90 days	
Maternity (3rd birth)	75 days	
Nursing breaks	Two breaks (min 30 min each) for 24 months	Combinable into one paid hour (Article 123)
Additional unpaid	Up to 1 month on request	Article 121
Paternity leave	Not statutory	May be granted under INARA policy

Other Statutory Leave

Leave type	Entitlement	Key notes
Marriage leave	7 days, once during service	After 6 months service (Article 174)
Bereavement leave	5 days	Death of parent, child, sibling, or spouse (Article 175)
Hajj / pilgrimage	30 days (Muslims) / 7 days (Christians), paid, once	After 5 years service (Article 173)
Unpaid leave	Permitted	Subject to approval

8. Wages, Payroll, and Social Contributions

- Minimum wage is set by government decree and revised periodically; salaries are paid regularly (typically monthly), usually in Syrian Pounds (NGOs may use alternative currencies where operationally required), with payroll records maintained;
- Eligible employees are registered with the General Organization for Social Insurance (GOSI); employer and employee contributions are at statutory rates with periodic declarations;
- GOSI covers pensions, work injury, and old-age/disability protections.

9. Benefits and Insurance

Eligible employees are covered through GOSI (pension, work-injury, old-age/disability); health coverage is provided through public and social-insurance mechanisms (may be limited by context). INARA may provide supplementary benefits (private health insurance, hardship or risk-related support, transport/communication allowances) subject to policy, funding, and context; where access to national systems is limited, INARA implements alternative protective measures.

10. Termination and Notice Periods

Service	Minimum notice	Key notes
Less than 5 years	1 month	Applies to both parties
5 – 10 years	2 months	
More than 10 years	3 months	Standard maximum range

Pay in lieu of notice is permitted; notice does not apply for serious misconduct as defined by law; termination must rest on legitimate grounds, exercised in good faith, with documentation; unlawful or arbitrary termination may attract compensation.

11. Statutory End-of-Service Entitlements

LEGAL PROTECTION

No INARA severance schedule. End-of-service and any statutory severance are governed solely by Syrian law and, where applicable, the national social-insurance system. INARA does not set its own severance formula; the statutory position below is descriptive and must be confirmed with local counsel.

- End-of-service indemnity is a statutory right for eligible employees on termination, typically based on last salary and years of service (commonly one month's salary per year of service, subject to legal application);
- Employees registered with GOSI may have benefits partly covered through the system; employers ensure accurate calculation and timely payment;
- Disputes may be referred to the labour authorities or courts; the exact method varies by employment type, termination reason, and social-insurance status.

12. Disciplinary and Labour Compliance

Disciplinary action rests on valid, documented grounds; the employee is informed and given an opportunity to respond before any action, in line with fairness and due process; sanctions are proportionate and consistent; termination for misconduct is justified and documented. All action aligns with the Handbook's discipline procedure (Section 23).

13. Health, Safety, and Working Conditions

INARA provides a safe and healthy working environment, takes reasonable measures to prevent risks and occupational injuries, assesses risks regularly (particularly in field and high-risk areas), reports and manages incidents, and provides protective measures where required. Given the conflict-affected context, INARA implements enhanced duty-of-care measures, security protocols, and contingency planning.

14. Equality, Non-Discrimination, and Worker Protection

INARA provides equal opportunity without discrimination, ensures fair and transparent recruitment, conditions, promotion, and termination, prevents harassment, abuse, and exploitation, and applies internal standards above the statutory baseline; concerns may be raised through INARA reporting and safeguarding mechanisms.

15. Special Provisions

Provision	Requirement	Key notes
Employment of women	Protected	Maternity protections and workplace safeguards

Provision	Requirement	Key notes
Employment of minors	Regulated	Minimum age; restrictions on hazardous work
Work permits (foreign staff)	Mandatory	Subject to government approval
High-risk environments	Additional protections	For hazardous or field-based work
Social insurance	Mandatory for eligible employees	GOSI compliance

Statutory Compliance Summary

Area	Position (verify locally)
Social security	Mandatory registration with GOSI; employer and employee contributions per law.
Tax	Income tax withheld and remitted under Syrian tax law.
Mandatory insurance	GOSI: pension, work-injury, old-age/disability; end-of-service per law/social insurance.
Trade union rights	Recognized under Syrian law.
Grievance	Internal grievance per policy; statutory recourse to labour authorities.
Discipline	Documented grounds; opportunity to respond; due process before sanctions.
Redundancy	Per law; compensation for unlawful/arbitrary termination.
Occupational safety	OHS duties; safe environment, risk assessment, and incident reporting.
Safeguarding reporting	National child-protection reporting obligations apply.
Court jurisdiction	Syrian labour courts / competent authorities.
Mandatory protections	Protections for women and minors; non-waivable statutory rights; statutory end-of-service.

Governing Law and Conflict of Provisions

This annex is governed by the laws of the Syrian Arab Republic. In the event of conflict between the Global Handbook, this annex, and Syrian labour law, Syrian labour law prevails. Where INARA policy provides greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply. This annex must be read with the Global Handbook and all related policies.

Annex G — Ukraine

Employer identity: The employer of personnel in this country is the locally registered Employing Entity, which concludes contracts, runs payroll, registers staff with the relevant authorities, and holds statutory employment liability. INARA International acts as parent/grantor and is not the employer and not a party to local employment contracts; INARA standards apply through the contract and the partnership agreement.

Verification note: *The statutory figures in this annex reflect Ukrainian law as compiled for this edition and must be verified against current law and implementing regulations by local counsel before being relied upon. Any change must be notified to HR.*

IMPORTANT

Structural annex — complete before use. This annex provides the standard structure for Ukraine. Specific statutory figures and martial-law variations must be completed and verified by qualified Ukrainian counsel (Labour Code of Ukraine; Law No. 2136-IX on labour relations under martial law) before reliance. Items marked [verify] require local-counsel input.

1. Legal Framework and Applicability

Employment in Ukraine is governed primarily by the Labour Code of Ukraine and applicable legislation, including special rules under martial law (Law No. 2136-IX) and social-insurance regulations. This annex supplements the Global Handbook; Ukrainian law prevails where it differs.

These provisions supplement the Global Handbook and address only matters where local law differs from or adds to it. Where differences arise, Ukrainian labour law prevails. Where Ukrainian labour law gives greater protection or benefit, the more favourable provision applies; where INARA policy gives greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply.

2. Employment Categories and Contracts

Contract type	Description	Key notes
Indefinite	No fixed end date	Default form
Fixed-term	Defined duration	Where justified; [verify martial-law regimes]
Project-based	Linked to funding/project	Common in NGO sector

Contracts are written, in Ukrainian, formalized by employer order/decreed, with tax and unified social-contribution registration from the start. [Verify martial-law contracting rules with counsel.]

3. Probation Period

Probation is permitted where stated, up to the maximum set by the Labour Code. [Verify the current maximum and any martial-law variation.]

4. Working Hours and Workweek

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Standard hours	40 hours per week	With weekly rest
Weekly rest	At least one rest day	[Verify]
Adjustments	Possible for defined categories under martial law	[Verify]

5. Overtime and Compensation

Statutory overtime premium and limits apply. [Verify current rate and caps, including any martial-law variation.]

6. Public Holidays

Employees are entitled to public holidays announced by the authorities; observance and any martial-law suspension must be confirmed. [Verify.]

7. Leave Entitlements

Element	Requirement	Key notes
Annual leave	Minimum 24 calendar days/working year	Additional leave for certain categories [verify]
Sick leave	Employer + social insurance on certification	[Verify rates/duration]
Maternity / parental	Per Labour Code and social-insurance law	[Verify durations]

8. Wages, Payroll, and Social Contributions

- Minimum wage is set by law and revised periodically; salaries are paid at least monthly;
- State social insurance is funded by the unified social contribution (pension, temporary incapacity, work-injury, unemployment);
- Personal income tax and the military levy are withheld and remitted per Ukrainian tax law. [Verify current rates.]

9. Benefits and Insurance

Eligible employees are covered by mandatory state social insurance via the unified social contribution. INARA may provide supplementary benefits subject to policy, funding, and context.

10. Termination and Notice Periods

Resignation is on statutory notice; redundancy follows the Labour Code with statutory notice and procedure; termination must rest on lawful, documented grounds. [Verify notice periods and martial-law variations.]

11. Statutory End-of-Service Entitlements

LEGAL PROTECTION

No INARA severance schedule. End-of-service and any statutory severance are governed solely by Ukrainian law and, where applicable, the national social-insurance system. INARA does not set its own severance formula; the statutory position below is descriptive and must be confirmed with local counsel.

Statutory severance applies in defined cases under the Labour Code (for example, redundancy), calculated by law. [Verify current entitlements and amounts with counsel.]

12. Disciplinary and Labour Compliance

Disciplinary action rests on documented grounds with an opportunity to respond, per the Labour Code; all action aligns with the Handbook's discipline procedure (Section 23).

13. Health, Safety, and Working Conditions

INARA complies with OHS duties under Ukrainian law, including risk assessment that accounts for conflict-related security risks, and reporting and management of incidents.

14. Equality, Non-Discrimination, and Worker Protection

Ukrainian law provides strong equality and worker-protection guarantees; INARA provides equal opportunity, prevents discrimination and harassment, and applies internal standards above the statutory baseline.

15. Special Provisions

Protections include job and earnings preservation for mobilized employees; martial-law variations apply across hours, leave, and termination. [Verify all martial-law provisions with counsel.]

Statutory Compliance Summary

Area	Position (verify locally)
Social security	State social insurance funded by the unified social contribution (pension, temporary incapacity, work-injury, unemployment).
Tax	Personal income tax and military levy withheld; remitted per Ukrainian tax law. [Verify rates]
Mandatory insurance	Mandatory state social insurance via the unified social contribution.
Trade union rights	Strong freedom-of-association and trade-union rights under Ukrainian law.
Grievance	Internal grievance per policy; statutory recourse via labour-disputes commissions/courts.
Discipline	Documented grounds and opportunity to respond per the Labour Code.
Redundancy	Per the Labour Code, with statutory notice and procedure. [Verify]
Occupational safety	OHS duties under the law; risk assessment including conflict-related security risks.

Area	Position (verify locally)
Safeguarding reporting	National child-protection reporting obligations apply.
Court jurisdiction	Ukrainian courts / labour-disputes bodies.
Mandatory protections	Job/earnings preservation for mobilized employees; martial-law variations apply. [Verify]

Governing Law and Conflict of Provisions

This annex is governed by the laws of Ukraine. In the event of conflict between the Global Handbook, this annex, and Ukrainian labour law, Ukrainian labour law prevails. Where INARA policy provides greater benefit and is lawful, the higher standard may apply. This annex must be read with the Global Handbook and all related policies.

APPENDICES

Standard forms, declarations, and reference materials

These forms are completed with the relevant Employing Entity and may be adapted to local language and legal requirements.

Appendix A — Employee Acknowledgement Form

I confirm that I have received, read, and understood the INARA Global Employee Handbook and the annex applicable to my duty station, and I agree to comply with them.

- I understand the Handbook is incorporated into my contract by reference, subject to mandatory law and to my contract, which prevails in the event of conflict.
- I understand that discretionary provisions are non-contractual and may be amended with notice.
- I agree to comply with the Code of Conduct, Safeguarding, PSEA, Anti-Fraud, Confidentiality, and Data Protection requirements.
- I understand that breach of these standards may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Field	Detail
Employee name	
Position	
Employing Entity / Country	
Handbook version	

Name	Signature	Date

Appendix B — Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form

Complete on appointment, annually, and whenever circumstances change. Disclosure does not imply wrongdoing; it allows conflicts to be managed.

Declaration

Do you, or a family member, have any financial, personal, business, or other interest that could actually, potentially, or apparently conflict with your duties to INARA? (For example: a relationship with a vendor, partner, beneficiary, or colleague; outside employment; or a related-party transaction.)

Field	Detail
Nature of interest / relationship	
Party concerned	
Relevant role or decision	
Proposed mitigation	

I confirm the above is complete and accurate, and I will update it promptly if circumstances change.

Name	Signature	Date

For HR/Management use — mitigation approved by: _____ Date: _____

Appendix C — Confidentiality Agreement

In the course of my engagement with INARA / the Employing Entity, I may access confidential information, including information about beneficiaries, staff, donors, partners, operations, security, and finances. I agree that:

- I will keep all confidential information secret and use it only as required to perform my duties;
- I will not disclose confidential information to any unauthorized person inside or outside INARA;
- I will protect personal and beneficiary data in line with the Data Protection policy and applicable law;
- I will not copy, remove, or retain confidential materials except as authorized, and I will return or securely delete them on request or separation;
- These obligations continue after my engagement ends, subject to lawful protected disclosures and disclosures required by law.

Name	Signature	Date

Appendix D — Code of Conduct Declaration

I declare that I have read and understood the INARA Code of Conduct and agree to uphold it. In particular, I will:

- Act with integrity, impartiality, and professionalism, and in the best interests of the children and communities INARA serves;
- Treat colleagues, partners, and beneficiaries with respect and without discrimination, harassment, or bullying;
- Avoid conflicts of interest and never use my position for personal gain;
- Comply with safeguarding, PSEA, anti-fraud, security, and data-protection standards;
- Report any breach of the Code or any concern through the appropriate channel.

Name	Signature	Date

Appendix E — Safeguarding Declaration

I confirm that I have read and understood INARA's Child and Vulnerable Adult Protection standards (Section 16) and agree to comply with them. I specifically acknowledge that I must:

- Never be alone with a child or vulnerable adult in a private or unobservable place;
- Never sleep in the same room or bed as a child or vulnerable adult;
- Never physically discipline, harm, humiliate, or inappropriately touch a child or vulnerable adult;
- Report any safeguarding concern without delay through a safeguarding channel.

Disclosure

I confirm that I have disclosed any prior safeguarding finding, dismissal for misconduct, or relevant conviction, where lawful to ask. (Yes / No)

Name	Signature	Date

Appendix F — PSEA Declaration

I confirm that I have read and understood INARA’s Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA) standards and agree to comply with them. I acknowledge that:

- Sexual exploitation and abuse constitute gross misconduct and grounds for summary dismissal;
- Sexual activity with a child (under 18) is prohibited regardless of the local age of consent, and mistaken belief about age is not a defence;
- Exchange of money, employment, goods, services, or assistance for sex is prohibited;
- Sexual relationships with beneficiaries are prohibited;
- I must report any PSEA concern without delay and may do so confidentially.

Name	Signature	Date

Appendix G — Remote Work Agreement

This agreement records the terms of an approved remote or cross-border working arrangement, in addition to the contract and Handbook (Section 8).

Field	Detail
Employee name / position	
Approved work location (country, city)	
Employing Entity / EOR (if applicable)	
Working hours / core availability	
Equipment provided by INARA	
Start date / review date	

Employee Undertakings

- I will work only from the approved location and will not relocate my work location without prior written approval;
- I am responsible for my own right to work, immigration status, and personal tax obligations at my location, and I will disclose my actual country of work;
- I will maintain a safe, suitable workspace, secure connectivity, and confidentiality, and will comply with IT-security and data-protection policies;
- I will safeguard and return INARA equipment on request or separation.

Name	Signature	Date

Appendix H — Exit Clearance Form

Completed during offboarding to confirm handover, return of property, and final settlement.

Clearance item	Responsible	Status	Date / Sign
Handover of duties, files, and tasks completed	Supervisor		
INARA equipment returned (laptop, phone, devices)	IT / Admin		
Documents, ID, keys, access cards returned	Admin		
System / email / account access revoked	IT		
Work data securely transferred or deleted	IT / Supervisor		
Outstanding advances / obligations settled	Finance		
Final salary and accrued leave processed	HR / Finance		
Exit interview conducted (where applicable)	HR		

Employee acknowledgement of clearance:

Name	Signature	Date

Appendix I — Disciplinary Process Flowchart

Indicative sequence; gross misconduct may proceed directly to investigation and possible summary dismissal. All stages follow due process and local law.

Step	Action	Output
1	Concern identified (performance or conduct)	Initial assessment by supervisor / HR
2	Minor issue → informal counseling	Documented discussion and guidance
3	If unresolved or more serious → investigation	Fair, objective fact-finding (Section 20)
4	Notify employee of allegations; opportunity to respond	Written notice; meeting; right to be accompanied where applicable
5	Decision by appropriate authority	No action / warning / final warning / dismissal
6	Apply sanction proportionate to findings and law	Written outcome with reasons
7	Appeal to person not previously involved (where feasible)	Final decision; records retained

Appendix J — Reporting Channels Chart

Use the channel that is most appropriate and safe. You are never required to report through a person who may be implicated.

Concern type	First channel	Escalation
General workplace issue	Line manager	HR → Country Director
Grievance	Supervisor / HR	Senior manager (appeal)
Harassment / bullying	Supervisor / HR	Country Director → Senior Management
Safeguarding / PSEA	Safeguarding Focal Point / HR	Senior Management → Board route
Fraud / corruption	HR / Finance / line manager	Senior Management → Board route
Concern involving senior management / CEO	Independent Board reporting route	Board / Board-designated committee

Reports may be made openly or anonymously. Good-faith reporters are protected from retaliation; confidentiality is maintained so far as possible but cannot be guaranteed in all circumstances (Section 21).

Appendix K — Investigation Procedure Summary

Summary of the standard investigation process (Section 20); safeguarding investigations also follow Section 16.

Phase	Key actions
1. Intake & assessment	Receive report; assess seriousness and risk; decide whether to investigate; consider interim measures (e.g., suspension on full pay).
2. Planning	Appoint impartial investigator; define scope; identify evidence and witnesses; issue record-preservation hold.
3. Evidence gathering	Collect documents and data lawfully; preserve chain of custody.
4. Interviews	Interview the subject (informed of allegations) and witnesses separately; record accounts; protect from retaliation.
5. Analysis & findings	Weigh evidence on the balance of probabilities; document findings and recommendation.
6. Decision & outcome	Decision-maker (separate from investigator where feasible) determines outcome; communicate in writing.
7. Appeal & closure	Allow appeal where applicable; implement actions; retain records confidentially; capture lessons learned.

Appendix L — Definitions Glossary

Key terms are defined in full in Section 1 (Definitions and Interpretation). A summary reference is provided below; Section 1 prevails.

Term	Short reference
INARA International	U.S. 501(c)(3) parent / grantor; not the employer of Employing-Entity staff.
Employing Entity	Locally registered partner that employs staff and holds statutory liability.
Employee / Worker	Engaged under an employment contract / performs work personally per local law.
Consultant / Contractor	Engaged under a separate services or commercial agreement; not an employee.
Beneficiary	A person who receives INARA assistance or services.
Child	Any person under 18.
Vulnerable adult	An adult who may be unable to protect themselves from harm or who depends on others for care.
Supervisor / Manager / Country Director	Direct reporting lead / manager of staff or functions / head of an Employing Entity.
Misconduct / Gross misconduct	Below-standard conduct / serious wrongdoing that may justify summary dismissal.
Conflict of interest	Personal/financial/family interest conflicting with duties to INARA.
Duty station / Remote worker	Primary contractual work location / employee working substantially away from an office.
Family member	Spouse/partner and close relatives, and household members (see Section 1).
Protected characteristics	Characteristics protected under applicable law (see Section 1).